

TRADOC Pamphlet 600-4

The Soldier Green Book

GUIDE FOR INITIAL ENTRY TRAINING SOLDIERS



U.S. ARMY

AUGUST 2025



26 August 2025

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Headquarters, U.S. Army Training and Doctrine Command
Fort Eustis, Virginia 23604-5700

Foreword

Welcome to America's Army! You are joining the Profession of Arms, committed to supporting and defending the constitution of the United States. You have taken the first step on a journey that I'm confident will change your life forever. Upon completion of your Basic Combat Training, you will earn the title "Soldier" and with continued honorable service you will always be a "Soldier for Life".

The Army you are joining is a time honored, trusted profession that supports and defends the Constitution and the rights and interests of the American people. It's comprised of dedicated Soldiers and Army Civilians who perform their duty with discipline and to standard while striving for excellence.

Living the Army Ethic, including the Army Values of loyalty, duty, respect, selfless service, honor, integrity, and personal courage is the basis for our bond of trust with the American people and mutual trust with each other. Just like generations of Citizen-Soldiers who previously answered the call to defend America's freedoms. You are now joining a calling with a shared identity as trusted Army professionals.

Over the next several weeks, we will help you transition from a citizen volunteer to become a Soldier with character, competence, and commitment. We will develop you to be physically and mentally ready to accomplish the mission in the right way. I'm confident you are up to the task. I hope you will find this experience personally and professionally rewarding, and, if you let it, it will set you on a path of continued success. This We'll Defend!

David J. Francis
Lieutenant General, U.S. Army
Commander, Center for Initial Military Training

Soldier Information

Name _____

My Basic Combat Training (BCT)/One Station Unit Training (OSUT)/Advanced Individual Training (AIT) Company Chain of Command:

* Note: Use pencil

Company commander: _____

First sergeant: _____

Platoon leader: _____

Drill sergeant: _____

Drill sergeant: _____

Instructor/squad leader: _____

Instructor/squad leader: _____

My mailing address:

My battle buddy is...

My Sexual Harassment/Assault Response and Prevention (SHARP) Program Contacts: Fill in using a pencil upon arrival at BCT, AIT and/or OSUT, and first unit of assignment:

Unit victim's advocate:

Company: _____

Battalion: _____

Brigade: _____

Notes: _____

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Department of the Army
Headquarters, U.S. Army
Training and Doctrine Command
Fort Eustis, Virginia 23604-5700

*TRADOC Pamphlet 600-4

26 August 2025

The Soldier's Green Book

FOR THE COMMANDER:

David J. Francis
Lieutenant General, U.S. Army
Deputy Commanding General

OFFICIAL:

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "J. D. Barrett", with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

JASON D. BARRETT
Deputy Chief of Staff, G-6

History. This is a major revision to TRADOC Pamphlet 600-4. The portions affected by this revision are listed in the summary of change.

Summary. This pamphlet is the guide for all initial entry training Soldiers who join our Army Profession. It provides an introduction to being a Soldier and trusted Army Professional, certified in character, competence, and

*This pamphlet supersedes TRADOC Pamphlet 600-4, dated 12 March 2025.

commitment to the Army. The pamphlet introduces Soldiers to the Army Ethic, Values, Culture of Trust, History, Organizations, and Training. It provides information on pay, leave, Thrift Savings Plans, and organizations that will be available to assist you and your Families. The Soldier's Green Book is mandated reading and is maintained and available during Basic Combat Training/One Station Unit Training and Advanced Individual Training.

Applicability. This pamphlet applies to all active Army, U.S. Army Reserve, and the Army National Guard enlisted initial entry training conducted at service schools, Army Training Centers, and other training activities under the control of Headquarters, U.S. Army Training and Doctrine Command.

Proponent and exception authority. The proponent for this pamphlet is Commander, U.S. Army Center for Initial Military Training (ATMT-OP), 210 Dillon Circle, Fort Eustis VA 23604-5701. The proponent has the authority to approve exceptions or waivers to this pamphlet that are consistent with doctrine and training publishing regulations.

Suggested improvements. Users are invited to send comments and suggested improvements on DA Form 2028 (Recommended Changes to Publications and Blank Forms) directly to the U.S. Army Center for Initial Military Training (ATMT-OP), 210 Dillon Circle, Fort Eustis, VA 23604-5701, usarmy.jble.tradoc.mbx.dcg-imt-g7@army.mil.

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Army training locations that conduct Basic Combat Training and One-Station-Unit Training.

Summary of Changes

TRADOC Pamphlet 600-4 The Soldier's Green Book

This major revision, dated 26 August 2025 -

- o Changes pamphlet name from Blue Book to Green Book and removes content that can be found in The United States Army Blue Book (throughout).
- o Inserts The United States Army Blue Book QR Code (Introduction).
- o Removes Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Accessibility policy and programs per Executive Order 14151 (throughout).
- o Removes Basic Combat Training Calendar and notes pages.
- o Inserts section on the U.S. Constitution (para 1-8).
- o Removes "Who we are not" section (chap 2).
- o Removes Army Values figure (chap 2).
- o Removes Drill Sergeant Creed figure (chap 4).
- o Removes "Separate and secure environment" section (chap 4).

- o Removes “What is the difference between Drill Sergeants and Platoon Sergeants” section (chap 4).
- o Changes Army Combat Fitness Test to Army Fitness Test (throughout).
- o Removes Standing Power Throw figure (chap 7).
- o Removes the following figures: Go for Green, Are you Hydrated, and Operation Supplement Safety (chap 8).
- o Removes Performance Readiness Bars and Multivitamin with Iron Program sections and related figures (chap 8).
- o Changes Hygiene to Basic Hygiene Principles (para 8-4).
- o Removes section on Male Health and Hygiene (chap 8).
- o Removes section on Female Health and Hygiene (chap 8).
- o Inserts H2F QR code (chap 8).
- o Renames Chapter 11 from First Unit of Assignment to Sponsorship and Soldier for Life.
- o Removes unit assignment, promotion, time in service, and army career tracker information (chap 11).
- o Removes, updates, and condenses information about Army resources (App B).
- o Removes Appendices C through G

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The “Green Book”

Introduction

Since 1775, U.S. Army Soldiers exhibited unwavering courage, self-discipline, military expertise, and esprit de corps, through tough, challenging military training and combat operations. Soldiers, like you, volunteered to serve and fight to protect their families and friends from enemies that sought to do us harm, and to defend the ideals of our nation.

We gain strength from training, and the basis for our training stems from a past deeply rooted in determination and adaptability.

From the beginning, American Soldiers were brave and fought with determination but were at a military disadvantage when fighting against highly trained and better organized British and Hessian Soldiers.



To win the Revolutionary War, General George Washington's Army needed training, discipline, and esprit de corps.

Seeking a solution, General Washington tasked Baron von Steuben with transforming the large group of hungry and exhausted men at Valley Forge into a disciplined fighting force. In the harsh Pennsylvania winter, Baron von Steuben instructed a company of future leaders in basic military

movements and tactical skills; those individuals were the predecessors of our Drill Sergeants!

He developed those cadre members until they could, in turn, train the entire Revolutionary Army in the art of basic military maneuvers. Through their perseverance and sense of duty, these dedicated troops achieved the highest standards. As a result, Washington's men fought skillfully and demonstrated the discipline of a professional Army. Ultimately, the Army won the Revolutionary War and independence after 8 years of fighting.

Training to standard and developing the commitment to adapt and overcome adversity became the hallmarks of the American Soldier. Baron von Steuben, by then the Army Inspector General, wrote the *Regulations for the Order and Discipline of the Troops of the United States*—now commonly referred to as the Soldier's Green Book—an instructional guide for future generations. This book consists of detailed training procedures, the standards of military conduct, and the fundamentals every Soldier needs to know.

Use this Soldier's Green Book on the journey you are about to undertake. Just as the Soldiers before you trained to serve and protect our Nation, this book will help you to learn, train and perform the tasks required of you to become Soldiers in the U.S. Army.

The Army's "Blue Book" is to inform Soldiers why we serve, provide historical information, and prescribe standards for appearance and conduct of all Soldiers. The men and women of the U.S. Army make up a highly disciplined fighting force that embodies the lineage of our nation and

Army. All Soldiers will use the Army Blue Book and its associated regulations to strengthen, enable, and demonstrate the Army Profession through enforced standards and discipline.

The QR code below links directly to The United States Army Blue Book.



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Chapter 1 – The Army

On 14 June 1775, the Second Continental Congress established “the American Continental Army.” The U.S. Army is the senior Service of the Armed Forces. As one of the oldest American institutions, it predates the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution. For almost two and a half centuries, Army forces have protected this, Nation. Our Army flag is adorned with over 190 campaign and battle streamers to date, each one signifying great sacrifice on behalf of the Nation.

The Army’s mission is to fight and win the Nation’s wars through prompt and sustained land combat, as part of the joint force.



1-1. Why we have an Army

It is the intent of Congress to provide an Army that is capable, in conjunction with the other armed forces, of-

Preserving the peace and security, and providing for the defense of the United States, the Commonwealths and possessions, and any areas occupied by the United States.

Supporting the national policies; Implementing the national objectives; and

Overcoming any nations responsible for aggressive acts that imperil the peace and security of the United States.

Title 10, U.S. Code, Section 7062(a)



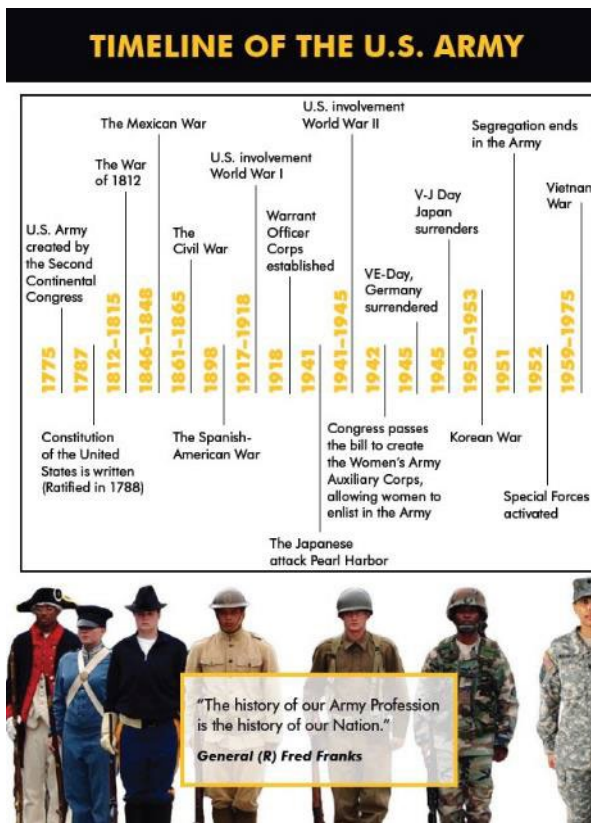


Figure 1-1. Army timeline

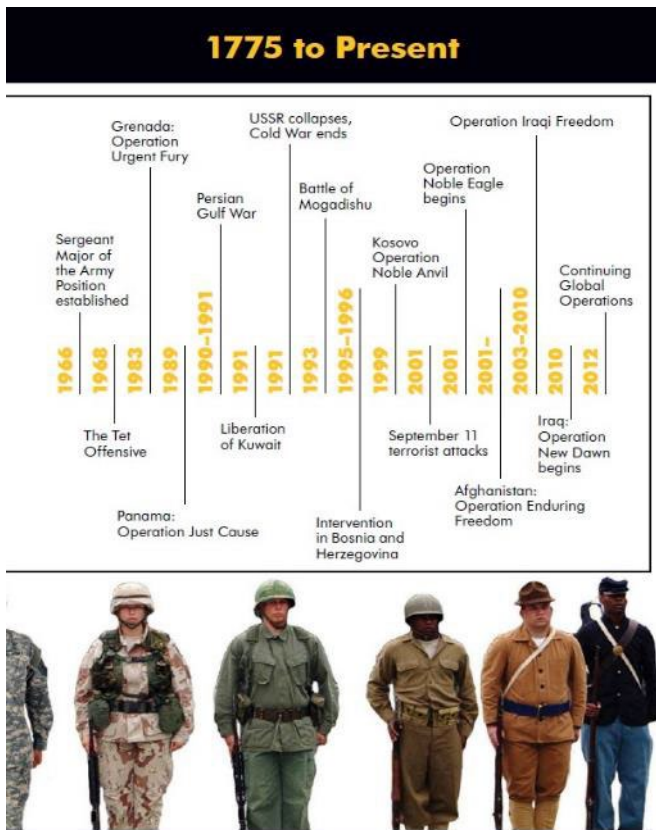


Figure 1-2. Army timeline - 1775 to present

1-2. What the Army uniform represents

Army uniforms include those designed for formal occasions, duty within an office or in garrison, and for tactical training and operations. Wearing the uniform of a U.S. Army Soldier is an honor and a privilege which must be earned. When we take our Oath of Service and are authorized to wear the uniform, we incur a sacred obligation to live by and uphold the moral principles of the Army Ethic and perform our duty professionally.

For Army Families, the uniform is a source of both pride and sacrifice.

Living by and upholding the Army Ethic is our life-long commitment. For our veterans, it represents one of the most important periods of their lives: pride in honorable service, accomplishments as part of a team, and a life-long connection to the comrades with whom they served, and in some cases, lost during their time in uniform.

When Soldiers return to society as private citizens, they are expected to continue to be moral-ethical role models for their Families and communities, contributing to the well-being of the United States of America, as *Soldiers for Life*.

For the American people, Soldiers are their sons, daughters, relatives, and neighbors. In us they see patriotism, honorable service, and courage.

Being seen as defenders of our freedoms you are expected to earn and sustain the trust of our society.

People around the world recognize the American Soldier as a symbol of the United States and its values, democracy,

and a commitment to defend the right of all people to life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness.

To our enemies, the Soldier represents American strength, resolve, and a commitment to defend the values that we hold dear as a Nation.

1-3. Why we serve

As Soldiers, we are committed to do our duty to contribute to the “common defense;” we share a love of our country and of our Army Family; we defend American values that frame the nation as expressed in the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution of the United States; and we serve “not to promote war, but to preserve peace.”

1-4. The Army’s Motto – “This We’ll Defend”

The Army’s motto remains as relevant today as it did at our Nation’s founding. The pronoun “We” reinforces our collective team effort and “Defend” remains our Army’s main mission. The Army continues this pledge into the future, as we have done since 1775.



Department of the Army Emblem

1-5. Oath of Enlistment

Members of the American Armed Services swear or affirm to support and defend the Constitution of the United States—not a leader, people, government, or territory.

That solemn oath ties service in the Army directly to the founding document of the United States. The oath expresses a noble calling to honorable service on behalf of the American people.

We serve because we believe America must be defended by a Professional Army of Soldiers and Army Civilians who are inspired to honorably fulfill their Oaths of Service. We accomplish our missions as a team, partnering with the other armed forces in the joint community and with government services that dedicate themselves to defending the U.S. Constitution and protect the Nation's interests, at home and abroad, against all threats."

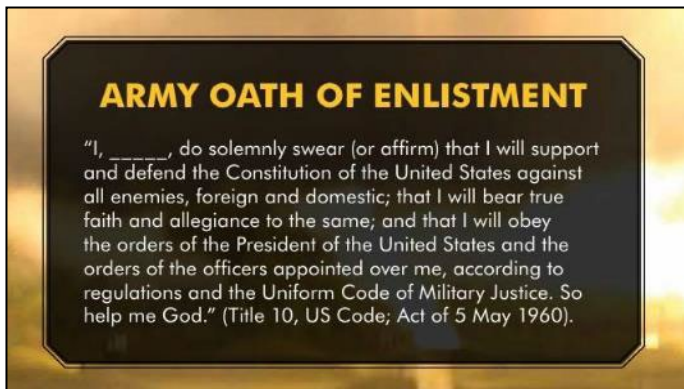


Figure 1-3. Army Oath of Enlistment

1-6. The Army Ethic

The Army Ethic, the heart of the Army

The Army Ethic includes the moral principles that guide our decisions and actions as we fulfill our purpose to support and defend the U.S. Constitution and our way of life. Living the Army Ethic is the basis for our mutual trust with each other and the American people. Today our ethic is expressed in laws, values, and shared beliefs within American and Army cultures. The Army Ethic motivates our commitment as Soldiers and Army Civilians who are bound together to accomplish the Army mission as expressed in our historic and prophetic motto: *This We'll Defend*.

Living the Army Ethic inspires our shared identity as trusted Army professionals with distinctive roles as *honorable servants*, *Army experts*, and *stewards of the profession*. To honor these obligations we adopt, live by, and uphold the moral principles of the Army Ethic.

Beginning with our solemn oath of service as defenders of the Nation, we voluntarily incur the extraordinary moral obligation to be trusted Army professionals.

Trusted Army professionals are Honorable Servants of the Nation—Professionals of Character:

We serve honorably—according to the Army Ethic— under civilian authority while obeying the laws of the Nation and all legal orders; further, we reject and report illegal, unethical, or immoral orders or actions.

We take pride in honorably serving the Nation with integrity, demonstrating character in all aspects of our lives.

In war and peace, we recognize the intrinsic dignity and worth of all people, treating them with respect.

We lead by example and demonstrate courage by doing what is right despite risk, uncertainty, and fear; we candidly express our professional judgment to subordinates, peers, and superiors.

Army experts—Competent professionals:

We do our duty, leading and following with discipline, striving for excellence, putting the needs of others above our own, and accomplishing the mission as a team.

We accomplish the mission and understand it may demand courageously risking our lives and justly taking the lives of others.

We continuously advance the expertise of our chosen profession through life-long learning, professional development, and our certifications.

Stewards of the Army Profession—Committed professionals:

We embrace and uphold the Army Values and standards of the profession, always accountable to each other and the American people for our decisions and actions.

We wisely use the resources entrusted to us, ensuring our Army is well led and well prepared, while caring for Soldiers, Army Civilians, and Families.

We continuously strengthen the essential characteristics of the Army Profession, reinforcing our bond of trust with each other and the American people.

1-7. Standards and principles of ethical conduct

You are now part of an Army culture of trust. The Army Profession sets high standards of conduct and expectations for Soldiers to live up to not only laws and regulations, but also the moral principles of the Army. As a Soldier, you are also a member of the Executive Branch of the U.S. government. Your actions must uphold the letter and the spirit of US laws and regulations governing ethical conduct. The President has issued Executive Order 12731, known as the “14 General Principles of Ethical Conduct.” These principles summarize the ethics, laws, and regulations all Soldiers must follow:

1. Public service is a public trust, requiring Soldiers to place loyalty to the Constitution, the laws, and the ethical principles above any private gain.
2. Soldiers will not hold financial interests that conflict with the conscientious performance of their duty.
3. Soldiers will not engage in financial transactions using Government information that isn’t available to the general public or allow the improper use of such information to further any private interest.
4. All Soldiers will not, except as permitted by the Standards of Ethical Conduct, solicit, or accept any gift or other item of monetary value from any person or entity seeking official action from, doing business with, or conducting activities regulated by the Army, or whose interests may be substantially affected by the performance or nonperformance of the Soldier’s duties.

5. Soldiers will always put forth honest effort in the performance of their duties.

6. Soldiers will not knowingly make unauthorized commitments or promises of any kind appearing to bind the Government.

7. Soldiers will not use their public office for private gain.

8. Soldiers will act impartially and not give preferential treatment to any private organization or individual.

9. Soldiers will protect and conserve Federal property and will only use it for authorized activities.

10. Soldiers will not engage in outside employment or activities, including seeking or negotiating for employment, that conflict with official Government duties and responsibilities.

11. Soldiers will disclose waste, fraud, abuse, and corruption to appropriate authorities.

12. Soldiers will satisfy in good faith their obligations as citizens, including all financial obligations, especially those -- such as Federal, State, or local taxes -- that are imposed by law.

13. Soldiers will adhere to all laws and regulations that provide equal opportunity for all Americans regardless of race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, or handicap.

14. Soldiers will avoid any actions creating the appearance that they are violating the law or the ethical standards set forth in the Standards of Ethical Conduct.

If you are ever confused as to what these requirements of ethical conduct mean, there are online and local resources to help make the right ethical decisions. One way to do that is to go to the Office of Army's General Counsel (Ethics & Fiscal) website at https://ogc.altess.army.mil/EandF/Documentation/ethics_material.aspx. Your base legal office has an ethics counselor for advice, or TRADOC Ethics Counselor at (757) 501-5757/5659.

1-8. The Constitution

The Constitution of the United States contains a preamble and seven articles that describe the way the government is structured and how it operates. The first three articles establish the three branches of government and their powers: Legislative (Congress), Executive (Office of the President), and Judicial (Federal Court System). A system of checks and balances prevents any one of these separate powers from being dominant. Articles four through seven describe the relationship of the states to the Federal Government, establish the Constitution as the supreme law of the land, and define the amendment and ratification process.

The Preamble to the United States Constitution, beginning with the words "We the People", is a brief introductory statement of the Constitution's fundamental purposes and guiding principles. Courts have referred to it as reliable evidence of the Founding Fathers' intentions regarding the Constitution's meaning and what they hoped the Constitution would achieve.

"We the People of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic Tranquility, provide for the common defence, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty to ourselves and our Posterity, do ordain and establish this Constitution for the United States of America"

Chapter 2 – The Army as a Profession

2-1. The Army Profession

Our shared identity, as *trusted Army professionals*, derives from our shared understanding of and respect for those whose legacy we celebrate. We honor this cherished inheritance in our customs, courtesies, and traditions. Units and organizations preserve their storied histories and proudly display distinctive emblems (regimental colors, crests, insignia, patches, and mottos). The campaign streamers on the Army flag remind us of our history of honorable service to the Nation. These symbols recall the sacrifices and preserve the ties with those who preceded us.

The essential Characteristics of the Army profession are Trust, Military Expertise, Honorable Service, Stewardship and Esprit de Corps.

Five Essential Characteristics of the Army Profession



Figure 2-1. Army Profession

Our Army Profession includes two mutually supporting communities of practice—

- The Profession of Arms: Soldiers of the Regular Army, Army National Guard, and U.S. Army Reserve.
- The Army Civilian Corps composed of civilian professionals serving in the Department of the Army.

The Army Ethic: The heart of the Army and the inspiration for our shared professional identity – Who we are and why and how we serve. It motivates and guides our conduct as Soldiers and Army Civilians who are bound together with the Army Culture of trust in common moral purpose.

2-2. What it means to be a Soldier

Soldiers are trusted professionals of character, competence, and commitment. The Army is an honored profession, founded on the bedrock of trust – trust among leaders, peers, and subordinates; between Soldiers and Army Civilians; trust in the Army professionals, and their families; and trust between the Army and the American people. By our solemn oath, we are morally committed to support and defend the Constitution. This duty requires a foundation of trust with the American people who grant us autonomy to use lethal force on their behalf, only because we have earned their trust. Army professionals understand and accept that they may give their lives and justly take the lives of others to accomplish the mission. The moral implications of this realization compel essential bonds of mutual trust within cohesive teams. The Nation tasks the Army to do many things besides combat operations, but ultimately, the mission of the U.S. Army is to fight and win our Nation's wars through prompt and sustained land combat as part of the joint force. The Army and each of its members must maintain the readiness to accomplish this mission, now and in the future. **Once a Soldier, always a Soldier...A Soldier for Life.**

2-3. The Army's commitment to you

Our commitment to you is to help guide you on this journey from an aspiring member of the Army Profession to a Soldier who is certified in character, competence, and commitment.

We are committed to providing you with a safe and secure environment where everyone can live, train, and learn, while developing into Soldiers of...

- Character: Soldiers who understand, adhere to, and uphold the Army Ethic, as demonstrated by their decisions and actions.
- Competence: Soldiers who demonstrate the ability to perform their duty with discipline and to standard.
- Commitment: Soldiers who demonstrate the resolve to contribute honorable service to the Nation and accomplish the mission despite adversity, obstacles, and challenges.

In turn, you join the ranks of generations of Soldiers who previously answered the call to defend America's freedoms; you join a band of brothers and sisters who are prepared to serve this Nation in peace and in war; and you join the Army Profession, a profession dedicated to upholding the values and ideals of our Country and its people that we serve and represent.

Our desired outcome as you complete your initial certification process is to provide the Army with a Soldier:

- Competent in basic combat skills and unique specialties.
- Who is a disciplined individual of character.
- Who is physically fit and ready to execute required Soldier and occupational specialty skills.
- Acculturated with Army Values, the Soldier's Creed, and Army history.
- Who is a trusted member of the Army team.

- Committed to serving the Army and Nation.
- Who is mentally capable and committed to serve as a trusted member of a team in their first unit of assignment.

2-4. The journey begins

When you took the Oath of Enlistment, you became a member of the Army Profession, albeit an aspiring professional.

The task at hand is to develop and certify you in Character, Competence, and Commitment. The responsibility for everyone's development and certification is a mutual one, a trusted bond, shared between you, your leaders, and the Army.

The first certification in becoming an Army Professional includes demonstrating the knowledge and skills to serve as a trusted Soldier in your first unit of assignment.

2-5. Army Values

Our ethical and moral foundation as Soldiers is solidified in the seven Army Values: Loyalty, Duty, Respect, Selfless Service, Honor, Integrity, and Personal Courage.

They are at the core of who we are as individuals, as Soldiers, as Professionals and as Americans. Whether on or off-duty, Soldiers live these values every day.

The easiest way to remember the Army Values is through the acronym "LDRSHIP".

LOYALTY: Bear true faith and allegiance to the U.S. Constitution, the Army, your unit, and other Soldiers.

Bearing true faith and allegiance is a matter of believing in and devoting yourself to something or someone. A loyal Soldier is one who supports the leadership and stands up for fellow Soldiers. By wearing the uniform of the U.S. Army, you express your loyalty. Doing your share displays loyalty to your unit.

DUTY: Fulfill your obligations.

Performing your duty means more than carrying out your assigned tasks. Duty means the ability to accomplish tasks as part of a team. The work of the U.S. Army is a complex combination of missions, tasks, and responsibilities — all in constant motion. Our work entails building one assignment onto another. You fulfill your obligations as a part of your unit every time you resist the temptation to take “shortcuts” that might undermine the integrity of the final product.

RESPECT: Treat people as they should be treated.

In the Soldier’s Code, we pledge to “treat others with dignity and respect while expecting others to do the same.” Respect is what allows us to appreciate the best in other people. Respect is trusting that all people performed their jobs and fulfilled their duty. Self-respect is a vital ingredient with the Army value of respect, which results from knowing you put your best effort forward. The Army is one team and each of us contributes something.

SELFLESS SERVICE: Put the welfare of the Nation, the Army, and your subordinates before your own.

Selfless service is larger than just one person. In serving your country, you are doing your duty loyally without thought of recognition or gain. The basic building block of selfless

service is the commitment of each team member to go a little further, endure a little longer, and look a little closer to see how he or she can add to the effort.

HONOR: Live up to all the Army Values.

The nation's highest military award is The Medal of Honor. This award goes to Soldiers who make honor a matter of daily living — Soldiers who develop the habit of being honorable and solidify that habit with every value choice they make. Honor is a matter of carrying out, acting, and living the values of respect, duty, loyalty, selfless service, integrity, and personal courage in everything you do.

INTEGRITY: Do what's right, legally and morally.

Integrity is a quality you develop by adhering to moral principles. It requires that you do and say nothing that deceives others. As your integrity grows, so does the trust others place in you. The more choices you make based on integrity, the more this highly prized value will affect your relationships with family and friends, and, finally, the fundamental acceptance of yourself.

PERSONAL COURAGE: Face fear, danger, or adversity (physical or moral).

Personal courage has long been associated with our Army. With physical courage, it is a matter of enduring physical duress and at times risking personal safety. Facing moral fear or adversity may be a long, slow process of continuing forward on the right path, especially if taking those actions is not popular with others. You can build your personal courage daily by standing up for and acting upon the things that you know are honorable.

Note: Information identified by a “star” ★ requires memorization.

2-6. The Soldier’s Creed

The Soldier’s Creed ★

I am an American Soldier.

I am a warrior and a member of a team.

I serve the people of the United States and live the Army Values.

I will always place the mission first.

I will never accept defeat.

I will never quit.

I will never leave a fallen comrade.

I am disciplined, physically and mentally tough, trained and proficient in my Warrior tasks and drills.

I always maintain my arms, my equipment and myself.

I am an expert and I am a professional.

I stand ready to deploy, engage, and destroy the enemies of the United States of America in close combat.

I am a guardian of freedom and the American way of life.

I am an American Soldier.

Figure 2-2. Soldier’s Creed

2-7. Expectations for Army Soldiers and Leaders

a. American Soldiers live the Golden Rule, Army Values, the Soldier's Creed, and the Warrior Ethos. Soldiers do their best, enforce standards, and get the job done. Soldiers persevere despite privation, chaos, and uncertainty; refusing to quit or lose.

b. American Soldiers are Skilled. Able to perform their tasks in the dark, in the rain, under fire, and without thinking about it. The rest of the Army can count on them to do their job.

c. American Soldiers are Tough. Army Tough... Resilient...mentally and physically. Tough and resilient enough to be comfortable being uncomfortable, to take a surprise or shock and bounce right back into the fight, to move as far and fast as necessary, and to fight as long and as hard as necessary to win.

d. American Soldiers are Ready to deploy, move, or fight. They are mentally prepared for anything.

e. American Soldiers are Alert. They "live on Amber." They pay attention to what is going on around them, see what is coming towards them, and notice when something is out of place. A curious scout is looking behind doors and underneath tarps on patrol. They have an edge in combat because they see bad things before they happen.

f. American Soldiers are confident. Confident in themselves, at their job, with their weapon, in their teammates and their unit.

g. American Soldiers act with disciplined initiative. Soldiers do the right thing even when no one is looking. Soldiers do not sit and wait for orders. They determine what needs to be done and do it without being told. Soldiers follow SOPs and orders but are smart enough to see when the plan is failing; no longer fits the situation or the enemy is presenting an opportunity; smart enough to come up with a new plan that will work and have the guts enough to do it.

h. Army Leaders lead by personal example. They share risks and hardships with their Soldiers. They lead by the concepts of mission command, mission orders and commander's intent to empower the disciplined initiative of their troops. They carefully plan, in advance, but stay flexible in execution. They are not afraid to take measured risks or to act decisively when the situation is uncertain.

i. Army Leaders are responsible and accountable for their decisions, their troops, and their equipment.

j. Army Leaders know that, foremost, they must train their Soldiers to fight, win, and come home alive. They know, "the more we sweat in peace, the less we bleed in war." They know we must practice being operationally effective in miserable conditions and we will fight like we train.

k. Army Leaders ensure their unit is secure, postured, and ready to move or fight on short notice. They check security before bedding down. They are never surprised by the enemy because they take precautions to prevent surprise.

Chapter 3 – The Reception Battalion

3-1. The Path

Welcome to the reception battalion. Being here means that you met your initial entry qualification requirements. While at the military entrance processing station (MEPS) you underwent a battery of aptitude tests and medical examinations to determine if you were qualified for military service. Congratulations, you passed!

You were vetted mentally, physically, and intellectually, by passing the Occupational Physical Assessment Test (OPAT), and the Armed Services Vocational Aptitude Battery (ASVAB). You know your future military occupational specialty (MOS) – what your job entails and qualified for that job by taking and passing the OPAT and were sworn into the U.S. Army. Now it's time for you to begin the transformation to becoming a Soldier.

You are at one of the following **BCT/OSUT** locations:

- Fort Moore, Georgia
- Fort Jackson, South Carolina
- Fort Leonard Wood, Missouri
- Fort Sill, Oklahoma

If your MOS is 11B/11C (Infantryman), 19D (Cavalry Scout), 19K (Armor Crewman), 12B (Combat Engineer) or 31B (Military Police Officer), you will conduct your BCT and occupational skills training in one course. This is called “One Station Unit Training” or “OSUT”. OSUT is conducted at Fort

Moore for 11B and 19K Soldiers, and at Fort Leonard Wood for 12B and 31B Soldiers.

All other Soldiers will go through BCT at one of the four locations listed above, and upon completion, will attend a follow-on course called “Advanced Individual Training” or “AIT.” This course may be at the same installation as your BCT training or may be at another location.

At the successful completion of OSUT or AIT, you will be awarded your MOS and receive a basic understanding of character, competence, and commitment as a *trusted Army professional and Soldier for Life*.

While at the reception battalion, you will undergo further medical and dental processing. Medical and dental processing includes collection of blood for certain immunities, type, and deoxyribonucleic acid (known as DNA); hearing and vision exams (in addition to the MEPS exams); pregnancy screening; tuberculosis screening; immunizations; and a brief dental exam and x-rays. You will receive ear plugs, mouth guard, eyewear, eye protection, and personal protective items such as sunscreen. These are all items of “individual medical readiness” that you will maintain throughout your career.

You will also undergo further administrative processing (personnel and finance records, and security clearance if applicable).

You will receive a standard military haircut, be issued your initial clothing requirement, to include physical fitness and Army combat uniforms (ACUs), footwear and miscellaneous clothing items. You will be taught how to properly wear the

clothing issued and begin to learn the basics of military culture.

Your actions and ability to follow instructions will be monitored carefully. A drill sergeant or cadre member will take you through the stations required for you to enter the Army.

Follow all instructions and pay attention to detail. One of the key elements to being successful in the Army is to understand what is required of you and to ask questions if you are unsure.

A typical stay in the reception battalion lasts 3-5 days for BCT Soldiers and 5-7 days for OSUT Soldiers.

After completing reception in-processing, you will be assigned to a training company. Drill sergeants will pick you up at the reception battalion and travel with you to your BCT or OSUT company location.

3-2. Critical information needed upfront

During your stay at the reception battalion, BCT or OSUT, you are expected to read, study, and memorize necessary information. The purpose of the information is to introduce and reinforce who we are as Army Professionals and what we represent as Soldiers. Your job is to fully understand, comprehend and demonstrate your proficiency by reciting it to the drill sergeant and leaders either individually or as a group.

3-3. The Battle Buddy System ★

Soldiers rely on one another to stay motivated and reach peak performance. Although required in Initial Military

Training, Soldiers will form natural bonds with their fellow Soldiers as part of Army culture. To contribute to this team spirit, we live by the buddy system. A buddy team is usually defined as two Soldiers (same sex) in the same unit who always look after each other.

By getting to know other Soldiers on a professional and personal level, you learn how to improve yourself and encourage others. Working together, you and your battle buddy learn initiative, responsibility, trust, and dependability.

While at the reception battalion, BCT or OSUT, Soldiers are placed in buddy teams. With the requirement to excel in Army training, some Soldiers need more positive reinforcement than others. For that reason, you may also be paired based on your strengths, so you and your buddy can complement each other's weaknesses.

Battle buddy responsibilities:

- Never leave your buddy alone.
- Never let your buddy go into an office or room by themselves; even if a drill sergeant, or instructor says it's okay (If it happens, report it).
- Keep your buddy safe and free from harm.
- Always know the whereabouts of your buddy.
- Pass information to your buddy.
- Encourage and support your buddy to train harder and do better.
- Help your buddy solve problems.

- Inform Cadre of any changes in your buddy's behavior.

In the end, the most rewarding part of the buddy system is making *every* Soldier your buddy; any buddy could help you accomplish your mission or save your life.

3-4. Suicide prevention

Everyone has the power and responsibility to protect Soldiers on and off the battlefield. This includes recognizing uncharacteristic and suicidal behaviors.

Effective suicide prevention requires everyone in the unit to be aware of the risk factors for suicide and know how to respond. Commanders, noncommissioned officers (NCOs), supervisors and battle buddies must lead the way.

If a Soldier displays warning signs (listed below), the time to act is NOW. Talk to the Soldier before it is too late.

What to look for: Warning signs

Distress can lead to the development of unhealthy behaviors. People closest to the Soldier (fellow Soldiers, family, and friends) are in the best position to recognize changes due to distress and to provide support.

Look For:

- Comments that suggest thoughts or plans of suicide.
- Rehearsal of suicidal acts.
- Giving away possessions.
- Obsession with death and dying.

- Uncharacteristic behaviors.
- Significant change in performance.
- Appearing overwhelmed by recent stressor(s).
- Depressed mood; hopelessness.
- Withdrawal from social activities.
- Sleep difficulties.
- Transitional periods.
- Medical, behavioral, or disciplinary problems.
- The severing or breakup of a close personal relationship.

3-5. Warrior Ethos

The Warrior Ethos—within the Soldier's Creed—describes a Soldier's selfless commitment to the nation, the mission, and fellow Soldiers.

All Soldiers are warriors—prepared, trained and fully equipped for war. Soldiers defeat the enemy in close combat, resolve conflict, and then restore the peace. They are also part of a team, bound to each other by integrity and trust.

As Soldiers, you are always under some level of physical and mental stress regardless of your rank or specialty.

Living by the Soldier's Creed and Warrior Ethos provides the inner strength and motivation you need to continue performing your duty and executing your mission.

3-6. The BCT/OSUT/AIT “Golden Rules” ★

#1 **DO NOT** bully, haze, assault or harass a fellow Soldier.

✓ DO help and assist your teammate.

#2 **DO NOT** use vulgar language, rude gestures, or discriminate against others.

✓ DO treat everyone with dignity and respect.

#3 **DO NOT** kiss, attempt to kiss, or touch a fellow Soldier.

✓ DO respect your teammate’s personal space.

#4 **DO NOT** steal or take something that does not belong to you.

✓ DO build trust with teammates through your ethical and disciplined actions.

#5 **DO NOT** go anywhere without your battle buddy.

✓ DO report violations of policies and regulations to your platoon and company leadership.

Chapter 4 – BCT/OSUT/AIT

4-1. What to expect

All phases of training develop character, competence, and commitment while instilling discipline. Training reinforces the Army Values, improves physical conditioning, and teaches basic combat and occupational skills. All of these contribute to the development of your individual skills and knowledge, resulting in a Soldier capable of serving as a member of a team in your first unit of assignment.

BCT/OSUT/AIT are training courses that transform civilians into Soldiers. Over the course of several weeks, you develop character, competence, and commitment and earn the right to be called a Soldier.

- BCT – 10 weeks
- 11B/C (Infantryman) OSUT – 22 weeks
- 12B (Combat Engineer) OSUT – 14 weeks
- 19D (Cavalry Scout) OSUT – 22 weeks
- 19K (Armor Crewman) OSUT – 22 weeks
- 31B (Military Police Officer) OSUT – 19 weeks, 1 day. AIT – Varies by Military Occupational Specialty

4-2. The training company – Your unit

Upon arrival to your training company, the drill sergeants and cadre will in-process you and assign you to a platoon, normally a group of 60 Trainees and three drill sergeants comprise a platoon size element.

Your drill sergeants are a mix of highly qualified male and female NCOs with 5-15 years of experience in the Army.

The company commander (captain) oversees the company. The commander establishes policy and has legal discipline authority over you and all assigned company personnel.

The platoon leader is responsible for accomplishing the platoon's training mission.

The first sergeant (1SG), who is the master trainer, assists the commander and supervises the drill sergeants and other Soldiers and Civilians assigned to the company.

There are typically 12 drill sergeants assigned to the company. They are responsible for the training and testing you receive. You will also see a supply sergeant (possibly a civilian) who is responsible for the linen, pillows, cleaning supplies and the work orders needed to maintain the company.

The training NCO or training officer/executive officer is responsible for updating and maintaining training records and the coordination of each day's training events.

4-3. Drill sergeants

A drill sergeant is a symbol of excellence in initial entry training (IET), an expert in all warrior tasks and battle drills, lives by and upholds the Army Values and Army Ethic, exemplifies the Warrior Ethos, and most importantly is the epitome of a trusted Army Professional.



A drill sergeant wears the distinctive “campaign hat” or “bush hat” and is responsible for coaching, counseling, mentoring, and transforming Trainees like you from a civilian volunteer to a combat-ready Soldier.

When addressing a drill sergeant your response will be, “Yes, Drill Sergeant” or “No, Drill Sergeant”. This is a form of respect to the drill sergeant and their position.

The badge has a specific meaning. It consists of 13 stars representing the original colonies. The torch, burning brightly in the center, symbolizes liberty. The snake is derived from the original “Don’t Tread on Me” serpent, a symbol of American independence during the Revolutionary War. Together with the torch and breastplate, it indicates readiness to defend. The breastplate is a symbol of strength. The green background is a vestment worn under the breastplate and called a jupon, which represents the new Army. The snake grasps, with its tail and teeth, a scroll inscribed with the U.S. Army’s motto “This We’ll Defend.”



The heritage of the drill sergeant and NCO reaches back to the Revolutionary War and carries through to today’s Army. Drill sergeants provide inspiration, discipline, and technical competence within unit formations.



4-4. The Soldierization process

Initial Entry Trainees/Soldiers complete a six-phase training program that prepares you for the transition from civilian volunteer to Professional Soldier. The advancement through each phase is a major “steppingstone” in your life because each stage repeatedly tests and pushes you to be your best.

In a highly supervised environment, you will experience training that challenges you physically and mentally.

Successful trainees model the actions, conduct, and adherence to the Army Values and Army Ethic exhibited by your drill sergeants.

Each of the six phases is essential. They are identified by colors; each phase signifies a specific turning point in becoming a Soldier.

The Yellow, Red, White, and Blue phases are part of BCT and the first 9 weeks of OSUT. The Black and Gold phases are part of AIT and the latter weeks of OSUT.

4-5. Daily schedule

Typical schedule during BCT

0500 – First Call/sick call

0530 – Physical readiness training

0630 – Breakfast

0830 – Training

1200 – Lunch

1300 – Training

1700 – Dinner

1800 – Drill sergeant time

2030 – Personal time

2130 – Lights-out

4-6. Basic Combat Training (BCT)

Yellow Phase. The first phase, or yellow phase, is focused on developing “Character and enhanced performance” through introduction to military customs and courtesies, discipline, standards, Army ethics, values, mutual trust, and teamwork. This phase is conducted in platoon size element within a controlled environment. Providing classroom instruction early in training ensures focus on standards and discipline, to include introduction to physical fitness.

Red Phase. You are integrated into the company environment and continue training as a company element until completion of BCT. You also continue participation in physical readiness training, road marches, confidence building exercises, and learn how to march in a military formation. You are required to complete the Hammer field training exercise (FTX), pass the initial evaluations, and demonstrate a level of functional fitness which allows you to meet follow-on physical fitness standards.

White Phase. Focus is on individual task proficiency. You learn rifle marksmanship and qualify on your assigned weapon. You continue your physical readiness training, negotiate an obstacle course, and train in the field on the basic Soldier skills known as “warrior tasks and battle drills” or “WTBDs”. These skills help develop your confidence to become a trusted member of the Army team. You must complete the Anvil FTX, pass all evaluations, and demonstrate a level of functional fitness and mental capacity to meet the demands of being a Soldier. At the end of white phase, you will earn your rifle qualification badge.

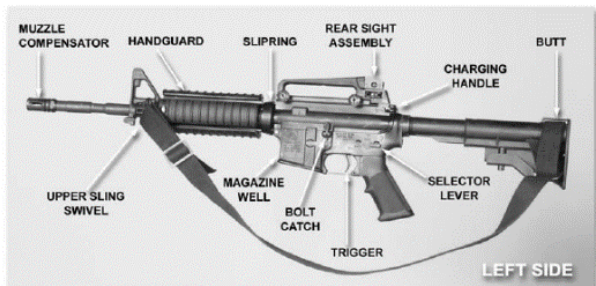


Figure 4-1. M4 carbine rifle left side



Figure 4-2. M4 carbine rifle right side

Blue Phase. This phase builds upon what you learned over the past three phases and reinforces the basic combat skills with a focus on teamwork and discipline. You will throw live hand grenades, train in chemical environments, conduct land navigation, and operate over multiple days in a field environment. After passing all your required tests and challenges during Forge, the final field training exercise, you earn the right to be called a Soldier, qualify to wear the Army patch, and wear the Army black beret as a rite of passage.



4-7. Warrior tasks and battle drills

The Army identified various basic warrior tasks and battle drills (WTBD) that all Soldiers are required to train and perform to succeed on the battlefield. These WTBDs are taught in BCT and cover critical skills associated with the ability to shoot, move, communicate, and survive in a combat environment.

While in the reception battalion, you received a copy of the Soldier Training Publication 21-1-Soldier's Manual of Common Tasks (STP 21-1-SMCT), Warrior Skills Level 1. The manual covers all the WTBDs you are required to know.

Shoot: You become proficient with your weapon and learn how to maintain, employ, and engage targets as well as how to properly handle and employ hand grenades.

- Maintain, employ, and engage targets with individually assigned weapon system.
- Employ hand grenades.

Move: You learn how to move tactically on the ground by practicing individual movement techniques. You learn how to navigate from one point to another and how to move as a member of a team.

- Perform individual movement techniques.
- Navigate from one point to another.
- Move as a member of a Team.

Communicate: Communication training focuses on using modern technology to convey information effectively. You

learn how to operate selected tactical Army communication equipment and to follow proper procedures to enable effective communication.

- Perform voice communications.
- Use visual signaling techniques.

Survive: Experience in handling the pressures of modern warfare is critical for Soldier survival. Practice in survival tasks helps you to properly react to hostile fire, enemy threats, and to maintain situational awareness.

- React to chemical, biological, radiological, and nuclear attack/hazard.
- Perform tactical combat casualty care lifesaving measures.
- Perform counter-improvised explosive device training.
- Maintain situational awareness.
- Assess and respond to threats (escalation of force)
- Construct an individual fighting position.
- React to small Unmanned Aircraft System (sUAS)

Battle drill: A battle drill is a collective action performed by a platoon, squad, or team that requires no planning, but is conducted as routine action when events dictate a response.

- React to contact.
- Establish security at the halt.

- Conduct Casualty Response Plan.
- React to ambush (near/far).



4-8. BCT graduation requirements

You must successfully accomplish the following requirements to graduate from BCT:

- ✓ Complete the Army Fitness Test (AFT) by scoring at least 60 points in each event. Goal is 65 points or higher in each event. Combat Arms MOS minimum 350 points.
- ✓ Safely handle, provide proper maintenance, zero, and qualify with your individual weapon using backup iron sights.
- ✓ Demonstrate proficiency in the wear of the chemical protective mask and complete the protective mask confidence exercise.
- ✓ Pass all internal and external evaluations.

- ✓ Negotiate Confidence, obstacle Courses, and the confidence Tower (must complete 70% of the available obstacles).
- ✓ Complete the Land Navigation Exercise.
- ✓ Complete Tactical Combat Casualty Care (TCCC) training.
- ✓ Conduct the hand grenade qualification course and employ two live grenades.
- ✓ Complete the 10-mile tactical foot march.
- ✓ Complete Buddy Team Live-fire Exercise.
- ✓ Complete the Buddy Team Fire and Movement “Force on Force” Exercise.
- ✓ Complete the Hammer and Anvil tactical field training.
- ✓ Complete the Forge field training exercise (FTX).

4-9. Military time

A Soldier is a 24-hour calling to honorable service and is only fitting that military time is expressed using 24 hours. As a global military force, the U.S. Army constantly coordinates with bases and personnel located in other time zones. To avoid confusion due to time differences, the military uses the Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) zones, where a phonetic alphabet is assigned to different regions across the world according to the number of hours they are East or West of the Prime Meridian. The military often refers to ZULU (Z) time zone, or UTC+00:00, which is also the time zone name for Greenwich, England. For example, 7:00 a.m. in UTC is written as 0700Z and spoken as “zero seven hundred Zulu”.

Table 4-1. Military time ★

Civilian Time	Military Time	Civilian Time	Military Time
12:00 Midnight	0000	12:00 Noon	1200
12:01 AM	0001	1:00 PM	1300
1:00 AM	0100	2:00 PM	1400
2:00 AM	0200	3:00 PM	1500
3:00 AM	0300	4:00 PM	1600
4:00 AM	0400	5:00 PM	1700
5:00 AM	0500	6:00 PM	1800
6:00 AM	0600	7:00 PM	1900
7:00 AM	0700	8:00 PM	2000
8:00 AM	0800	9:00 PM	2100
9:00 AM	0900	10:00 PM	2200
10:00 AM	1000	11:00 PM	2300
11:00 AM	1100	11:59 PM	2359

4-10. AIT/OSUT

Transition from BCT to AIT: Soldiers report to AIT on their scheduled report date. Soldiers who are authorized to travel to the AIT location with family members must arrive at the AIT location no later than 1800 on the Sunday prior to the scheduled AIT report date. Do not expect passes or privileges above what was allowed in BCT. Ensure you maintain accountability all of equipment, paperwork, and

any publications issued during BCT. The buddy system remains in place throughout your training.

In AIT and the final phases of OSUT, you are trained in your selected military occupational specialty (MOS) (job training) and continue the physical conditioning required to excel in your future unit.

During Black and Gold phases of AIT/OSUT, you will receive classroom instruction, hands-on training, and field training to enable you to become a valued team member as you transfer to your first unit of assignment.

Black Phase. The Black Phase is the first phase of comprehensive MOS training that occurs during weeks 10-13 of OSUT and the initial start of AIT.

This phase develops the skills in your Army specialty through hands-on training, classroom instruction, and opportunities to apply those skills during various training exercises.

During Personal Financial Management Training, you will receive 8 hours of specialized training in how to handle your finances. Upon completion of the finance training, you will be issued a certificate. Ensure you take this certificate to your first unit of assignment, or you will be required to retake the training.

Gold Phase. The Gold Phase is the final and most progressive stage that covers weeks 14-20+ of OSUT/AIT and the longer periods associated with specific MOSs. Some MOSs (AIT) may last 40 weeks or longer.

The phase ends with a tactical FTX, no less than 3 days and 2 nights (72 hours minimum) where you will apply the knowledge and experience you gained from BCT and most recent MOS training in a simulated combat environment.

Graduation requirements.

You must successfully accomplish the following requirements to graduate from OSUT/AIT:

- ✓ Complete the Army Fitness Test (AFT) scoring at least 60 points in each event. Goal is 70 points or higher in each event.
- ✓ Pass MOS-specific critical tasks as identified by the proponent school.
- ✓ Complete personal financial training course.
- ✓ Complete an FTX of no less than 3 days and 2 nights (Minimum 72 hours)
- ✓ Reinforce WTBDs taught in BCT (weapons handling, land navigation, communication skills, first aid training, and field craft).

During your entry into the Army, your training, and/or final phases of AIT/OSUT, if you visually appear to be marginal or exceed body fat content standards (see Army Regulation 40-501 Body Fat Standards), you will be taped to determine your body fat percentage. If your body fat exceeds the standards, you have six months (180 days) to meet weight/body fat compliance in Army Regulation 600-9.

4-11. General orders and special orders

General orders: ★

1. I will guard everything within the limits of my post and quit my post only when properly relieved.

2. I will obey my special orders and perform all my duties in a military manner.
3. I will report violations of my special orders, emergencies, and anything not covered in my instructions to the commander of relief.

Special orders: Additional requirements or instructions that augment the general orders.

4-12. Guard duty

One of the most important duties you perform in the Army is guard duty. In a combat zone or unit area, cautious guards can mean the difference between life and death. However, guards are important everywhere due to the terrorist threats that can occur.

Knowing your general orders and special orders, as mentioned earlier, helps prepare you for guard duty or other security requirements.

Reacting to an inspecting officer

When you are on guard duty or at any location performing security and approached by an inspecting officer, these steps are followed:

- Stop walking and assume the position of attention.
- When the inspecting officer approaches, render a proper hand salute.
- When the salute is returned, execute order arms.
- Remain at attention.
- The inspecting officer will command, "At ease."

- The inspecting officer may ask questions pertaining to your general orders, special orders, and what has transpired at your post.
- When finished with the inspection, the inspecting officer will say, "Carry on."
- Assume the position of attention and render a proper hand salute, holding it until it is returned.
- Resume your post.

Challenging unknown persons

The following steps are carried out when challenging unknown persons (night) and summoning the commander of the relief:

- Upon seeing or hearing an unknown person, come to port arms.
- Issue the command "Halt." (Person halts.)
- Call out "Who is/goes there?" Unknown person identifies him/herself.
- State "Advance to be recognized."
- Command "Halt," when the person can be seen but not closer than 2 to 3 meters away.
- Say "State your business." Unknown person states reason for presence in guarded area.
- Require the unknown person to place their identification on the ground and move back six steps.

- Check the identification while keeping the person under observation.
- If the identification and authorization do not match, move to the phone, and call the commander of the relief while keeping the person under observation.
- Release the person to the commander of the relief and explain that their identification and authorization do not match.

4-13. Phonetic alphabet ★

The phonetic alphabet is used to communicate letters under conditions where communications might be impaired. Use of the phonetic alphabet ensures accurate communication of similar sounding letters, such as B, C, D, G, P, T, and V.

Phonetic Alphabet	
A – ALPHA	N – NOVEMBER
B – BRAVO	O – OSCAR
C – CHARLIE	P – PAPA
D – DELTA	Q – QUEBEC
E – ECHO	R – ROMEO
F – FOXTROT	S – SIERRA
G – GOLF	T – TANGO
H – HOTEL	U – UNIFORM
I – INDIA	V – VICTOR
J – JULIET	W – WHISKEY
K – KILO	X – X-RAY
L – LIMA	Y – YANKEE
M – MIKE	Z – ZULU

Figure 4-3. Phonetic alphabet

Chapter 5 – Personal Appearance and Uniforms

5-1. Personal appearance

The Army is a profession. A Soldier's appearance projects part of his or her professionalism. Proper wear of the Army uniform is a matter of personal pride for all Soldiers. It is indicative of esprit de corps and morale within a unit.

Soldiers have an individual responsibility to ensure their appearance reflects the highest level of professionalism. Your uniform is only part of your appearance. To look like a Soldier, you need to be physically fit, meet acceptable weight standards, have a neat hairstyle in accordance with Army regulations, and always conduct yourself in a manner reflecting your professional status treating others with dignity and respect.

Note: While attending BCT/OSUT/AIT some of the personal appearance allowances may be restricted while undergoing training. Your drill sergeants, cadre, and instructors will inform you of these restrictions.

See Army Regulation (AR) 670-1 and/or DA Pamphlet 670-1 for additional inquiries concerning Army uniforms and awards.

Note: When traveling from BCT to AIT you will wear ACUs, or appropriate civilian attire, directed by the commander. The Army Green Service Uniform (AGSU) may be directed by the Commander when traveling to AIT, Holiday Block Leave, or other authorized leave locations.

Grooming standards for male personnel

While at BCT, males will receive a standard haircut. Upon graduation from BCT, individualized haircuts may be authorized, if they conform to AR 670-1. Most Army Air Force Exchange Store (AAFES) barbers have a poster which shows authorized haircut styles.



The hair on top of the head must be neatly groomed. The length and bulk of the hair may not be excessive and must present a neat and conservative appearance.

- Hair must present a tapered appearance.
- Neither the bulk nor length of hair may interfere with the wearing of military headgear.
- Sideburns must be neatly trimmed, not flared, not come to a point, and must not extend downward beyond the lowest part of the exterior ear opening.
- Soldiers must be clean-shaven when in uniform or civilian clothes while on duty, or with temporary exemptions for medical reasons and permanent exemptions for religious accommodation. Army

Directive 2025-13, Facial Hair Grooming Standards, 07JUL2025 prohibits permanent shaving profiles.

- If a mustache is worn after graduation from BCT/OSUT/AIT, it must be neatly trimmed.
- No part of the mustache will cover the upper lip line or extend horizontally beyond or below the corner points of the mouth where the upper and lower lips join.

Grooming standards for female personnel

While at BCT, females are not required to receive a standard haircut. The requirements for hair regulations are to maintain uniformity within a military population for female Soldiers while in uniform, or in civilian clothes on duty, unless otherwise specified. Hairstyles may not be eccentric or faddish and will present a conservative, professional appearance. For the purpose of these regulations, female hairstyles are organized into three basic categories: short length, medium length, and long length hair. See AR 670-1 for more information.

Short length

Short hair is defined as hair length that extends no more than 1 inch (25.4 millimeter) from the scalp (excluding bangs). Hair may be no shorter than 1/4 inch (.25 millimeter) from the scalp (unless due to medical condition or injury) but may be evenly tapered to the scalp within 2 inches (50.8 mm) of the hair line edges. Bangs, if worn, may not fall below the eyebrows, may not interfere with the wear of all headgear, must lie neatly against the head, and not be

visible underneath the front of the headgear. The width of the bangs may extend to the hairline at the temple.

Medium length

Medium hair is defined as hair length that does not extend beyond the lower edge of the collar (in all uniforms) and extends more than 1 inch (25.4 mm) from the scalp.

Medium hair may fall naturally in uniform and is not required to be secured. When worn loose, graduated hair styles are acceptable, but the length, as measured from the end of the total hair length to the base of the collar, may not exceed 1 inch (25.4 mm) difference in length, from the front to the back. Layered hairstyles are also authorized, so long as each hair's length, as measured from the scalp to the hair's end, is generally the same length giving a tapered appearance. The regulations for the wear of bangs detailed above apply. No portion of the bulk of the hair, as measured from the scalp, will exceed 2 inches (50.8 mm).

Long length

Long hair is defined as hair length that extends beyond the lower edge of the collar. Long hair will be neatly and inconspicuously fastened or pinned, except that bangs may be worn. The regulations for the wear of bangs detailed above apply. No portion of the bulk of the hair, as measured from the scalp, will exceed 2 inches (50.8 mm) (except a bun, which may extend a maximum of 3 inches (76.2 mm) from the scalp) and be no wider than the width of the head. Long length hair may be worn in a ponytail **during** physical training. A single ponytail centered on the back of the head is authorized only when within the scope of physical training,

except when considered a safety hazard. The ponytail is not required to be worn above the collar.

When hair securing devices are worn, they will comply with the guidelines. Hairstyles, otherwise authorized in this chapter (such as braids and twists) may also be worn in a ponytail during physical training.

Braids, cornrows, and twists

Medium and long hair may be styled with braids, cornrows, or twists (see glossary for definitions). Each braid, cornrow, or twist will be of uniform dimension, have a diameter no greater than 1/2 inch, (6.35 mm) and present a neat, professional, and well-groomed appearance. Each must have the same approximate size of spacing between the braids, cornrows, or twists. Each hairstyle may be worn against the scalp or loose (free hanging). When worn loose, such hairstyles must be worn per medium hair length guidelines or secured to the head in the same manner as described for medium or long length hair styles. Ends must be secured inconspicuously. When multiple loose braids or twists are worn, they must encompass the whole head. When braids, twists, or cornrows are not worn loosely and instead worn close to the scalp, they may stop at one consistent location of the head and must follow the natural direction of the hair when worn back, which is either in general straight lines following the shape of the head or flowing with the natural direction of the hair when worn back with one primary part in the hair. Hairstyles may not be styled with designs, sharply curved lines, or zigzag lines. Only one distinctive style (braided, rolled, or twisted) may be

worn at one time. Braids, cornrows, or twists that distinctly protrude (up or out) from the head are not authorized.

Dreadlocks or locks

Female Soldiers may wear dreadlocks or locks in accordance with the guidance for braids, cornrows, and twists.

Jewelry

A wristwatch, identification bracelet, and up to two rings (a wedding set is one other ring) may be worn with your uniform if they are conservative and tasteful. Soldiers may also wear one activity tracker, pedometer, or heart rate monitor. You may wear a religious medal on a chain around your neck provided neither medal nor chain can be seen.

Earrings may be screw-on, clip-on, or post-type earrings, in gold, silver, white pearl, or diamond. The earrings will not exceed 6 mm or 1/4 inch (6.35 mm) in diameter, and they must be unadorned and spherical. When worn, the earrings will fit snugly against the ear. Females may wear earrings only as a matched pair, with only one earring per ear lobe.

Note: Soldiers are not authorized to wear earrings with any class C (utility) uniform (ACU, hospital duty, food service, physical fitness, field, or organizational).

Body piercing

No displaying objects, articles, jewelry, or ornamentation attached or affixed to or through the skin may be worn while in uniform. Such adornments are not allowed while wearing civilian clothes (on or off duty) when on any military installation, or other places under military control. When not

in uniform and off duty, earring wear is not restricted if the earrings do not create or support ear gauging (enlarged holes in the lobe of the ear, greater than 1.6mm). Follow Army Regulation 670-1 guidance.

Cosmetics

Standards regarding cosmetics are necessary to maintain uniformity and to avoid an extreme or unprofessional appearance. Males are prohibited from wearing cosmetics, except when medically prescribed. Females are authorized to wear cosmetics with all uniforms, provided they are applied modestly and conservatively, and that they complement both the Soldier's complexion and the uniform. Leaders at all levels must exercise professional judgment when interpreting and enforcing this policy. Eccentric, exaggerated, or faddish cosmetic styles and colors, to include makeup designed to cover tattoos, are inappropriate with the uniform and are prohibited.

Permanent makeup, such as eyebrow or eyeliner, is authorized if the makeup conforms to the standards outlined above. Eyelash extensions are not authorized unless medically prescribed.

Females will not wear shades of lipstick that distinctly contrast with the natural color of their lips, that detract from the uniform, or that are faddish, eccentric, or exaggerated.

Females will comply with the cosmetics policy while in any military uniform or while in civilian clothes on duty.

Fingernails

All personnel will keep fingernails clean and neatly trimmed.

Males will keep nails trimmed so as not to extend beyond the fingertip.

Females will not exceed a nail length of 1/4 inch (6.35 mm) as measured from the tip of the finger. Females will also trim nails shorter if the commander determines that the longer length detracts from the military image, presents a safety concern, or interferes with the performance of duties.

Females may wear clear acrylic nails, provided they have a natural appearance and conform to Army standards.

Tattoos

Note: Violation of AR 670-1 tattoo policy by Soldiers may result in adverse administrative action and/or charges under the provisions of the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ).

Tattoos and brands are permanent markings that are difficult to reverse (in terms of financial cost, discomfort, and effectiveness of removal techniques). Before obtaining either a tattoo or a brand, Soldiers should consider talking to unit leaders to ensure that they understand the Army tattoo and brand policy. The words tattoo and brand are interchangeable regarding this policy.

The following types of tattoos or brands are prejudicial to good order and discipline and are, therefore, prohibited anywhere on a Soldier's body:

- **Extremist.** Extremist tattoos or brands are those affiliated with, depicting, or symbolizing extremist philosophies, organizations, or activities. Extremist philosophies, organizations, and activities are those which advocate racial, sex, or ethnic hatred or

intolerance; advocate, create, or engage in illegal discrimination based on race, color, sex, ethnicity, religion, or national origin; or advocate violence or other unlawful means of depriving individual rights under the U.S. Constitution, and Federal or State law (see Army Regulation 600–20).

- **Indecent.** Indecent tattoos or brands are those that are grossly offensive to modesty, decency, propriety, or professionalism.
- **Sexist.** Sexist tattoos or brands are those that advocate a philosophy that degrades or demeans a person based on sex.
- **Racist.** Racist tattoos or brands are those that advocate a philosophy that degrades or demeans a person based on race, ethnicity, or national origin.

Tattoos or brands, regardless of subject matter, are prohibited on certain areas of the body as follows:

Soldiers are prohibited from having tattoos or brands on the head, face (except for permanent makeup as provided in AR 670-1), or on/inside the eyelids, mouth, and ears.

Soldiers may have one visible tattoo on each hand (including the palm), not to exceed one inch in measurement in all directions; an unlimited number of tattoos between the fingers if they are not visible when the fingers are closed; and one ring tattoo on each hand.

Soldiers may have one tattoo on the back of the neck, not to exceed two inches (50.8 mm) in measurement in all directions.

Soldiers may have one tattoo behind each ear, not to exceed one inch in measurement in all directions, not to extend forward of the ear lobe.

Commanders will perform an annual check for new tattoos or brands in prohibited locations (see AR 670 – 1 for prohibited locations). If any new tattoos are found not in compliance with current standards, the Soldier must be processed in accordance with AR 670 – 1.

Accessing applicants must adhere to this same policy.

- Soldiers and applicants may not cover tattoos or brands with bandages or make up to comply with the tattoo policy.
- Soldiers are prohibited from any unauthorized form of body mutilation, which is the willful mutilation of the body or any body parts in any manner. This prohibition does not include authorized medical alterations performed at a medical treatment facility or cosmetic, reconstructive, or plastic surgery procedures the commander normally approves. Examples of unauthorized body mutilation include, but are not limited to, tongue bifurcation (splitting of the tongue), ear gauging (enlarged holes in the lobe of the ear that are greater than 1.6 mm), unnatural shaping of teeth, ear pointing (or “elfing”), scarification (cutting to create intentional scarring), or body modifications for the purpose of suspension (hanging by body hooks).

5-2. Army Combat Uniform in the Operational Camouflage Pattern (ACU OCP)

Boots

New boots should fit properly when you receive them.

- They should have a chance to air out between uses. Wear one pair one day and alternate to another pair the next. Continue to rotate daily.
- Scrape dirt or mud from boots and wash with just a little water and soap.
- Wipe insides dry with a clean cloth and remove all soapsuds from the outside.
- Stuff paper in the toes and let boots dry in a warm, dry place.
- Do not put boots in the hot sun or next to a strong source of heat.
- Let boots dry.
- Heels of boots should be replaced after wear of 7/16 of an inch (11.125 mm) or more.
- Conduct a 1-mile road march to assess feet swelling for confirmation of boot size and fit.

Insignia placement. Each Soldier is responsible for properly placing the correct insignia on the uniform, as follows:

Shoulder sleeve insignia (SSI)

The subdued SSI is worn on the Velcro pad of all field and utility uniforms, centered on the left sleeve.

Soldiers in both BCT and AIT who are in one of the following categories may wear organizational shoulder sleeve insignia.

- Army National Guard (ARNG) and U.S. Army Reserve (USAR) trainees are authorized to wear the insignia of their parent ARNG or USAR organization from the start of training.
- Unit-of-choice trainees are authorized to wear, from the start of training, the insignia of the specific unit for which they enlisted.

“U.S. ARMY” insignia

- Worn immediately above and parallel to the top edge of the left breast pocket.
- This insignia consists of black, 3/4-inch (19.05 mm) high block letters on a 1-inch wide by 4-1/2-inch (114.3 mm) long strip (or length extending to the edges of the pocket flap).

Rank insignia

Rank insignia is attached to the Velcro area provided in the center of the ACU OCP jacket flap. (See Figure 5-1 on page 71).

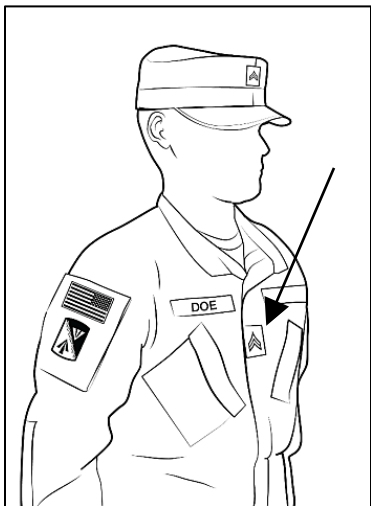


Figure 5-1. Rank insignia placement

Name tape

- Worn immediately above and parallel to the top edge of the right chest pocket of all field and work uniform coats and shirts.
- It consists of black letters on a 1-inch wide by 4-1/2-inch (114.3 mm) long (or to the edges of the pocket flap) strip of cloth.
- Names of 10 letters or less will be printed in 3/4-inch (19.5 mm) high Franklin Gothic Condensed.
- Names of 11 letters or more will be printed in 1/2-inch (12.7) high Franklin Gothic Extra Condensed.

- The name and U.S. Army tapes will be the same length.

Soldiers wear subdued (cloth) last name and U.S. Army identification insignia attached to Velcro. Soldiers may sew on the U.S. Army and rank insignia's, name tape, and all authorized badges, as an option.

Belts and Buckles

The rigger tan 499 belt will be worn with the ACU OCP.

The rigger belt is worn with the attached black, open face buckle. It is worn so that the tipped end passes through the buckle to the wearer's left; the end will not extend more than 2 inches (50.8 mm) beyond the edge of the buckle. The belt's end may be neatly trimmed to ensure a proper fit.

Patrol Cap

The patrol cap is the standard headgear worn with the combat uniform in the garrison environment. The patrol cap has a visor, circular top crown, side crown with an outside crown band, and a hook-and-loop pad on the back of the patrol cap.



Figure 5-2. Patrol cap

Soldiers will wear the patrol cap straight on the head so that the cap band creates a straight line around the head, parallel to the ground. The patrol cap will fit snugly and comfortably around the largest part of the head without bulging or distortion from the intended shape of the headgear and without excessive gaps. No rolling of, blocking, or alterations to the cap are authorized. Rank insignia is worn at the center front of the cap between the top seam and the bottom seam.

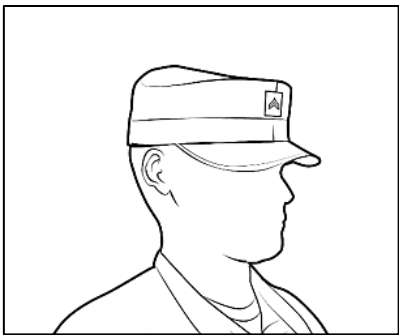


Figure 5-3. Wear of patrol cap

the shorts must end above the knee or higher. The commercial shorts must be plain, with no logos, patterns, or obtrusive markings. Soldiers are not required to buy spandex shorts. This is an optional purchase.

Only pregnant Soldiers are authorized to wear the APFU shirt outside of the trunks.

Commanders may authorize the wear of commercial running shoes, calf-length or ankle-length plain white/black socks with no logos, gloves, reflective belts or vests, long underwear, and other items appropriate to the weather conditions and type of activity. If Soldiers wear long underwear or other similar items, they must conceal them from view when wearing the running jacket and pants of the APFU.



Figure 5-5. Wear of Army physical fitness uniform

5-4. Enlisted Army Green Service Uniform

The Class A Army Green Service Uniform (AGSU) includes the heritage green 564 coat, a heritage tan 566 short- or long-sleeved shirt, heritage green four-in-hand necktie, heritage taupe 565 trousers for male Soldiers and slacks or optional skirt for female Soldiers, heritage walnut 567 belt, socks, and headgear.

The Class B AGSU includes a heritage tan 566 short- or long-sleeved shirt, heritage taupe 565 trousers for male Soldiers and slacks or optional skirt for female Soldiers, heritage walnut 567 belt, socks, and headgear. The four-in-hand heritage green necktie is optional when worn as the Class B uniform.



Figure 5-6. Enlisted Army Green Service Uniform (Male)

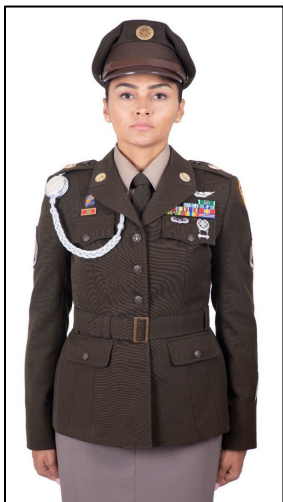


Figure 5-7. Enlisted Army Green Service Uniform (Female)

Insignias and Badges

U.S. and branch insignia

During IET, Soldiers will wear the "U.S." insignia disk on both collars of the AGSU coat. After completing AIT or OSUT, Soldiers will replace the "U.S." insignia on their left collar with the military occupational specialty branch insignia.

The bottom of the insignia disks will be approximately 1-inch above the notch where the collar meets the lapel, centered between the seam and the outside edge of the collar.

The centerline of the "U.S." and branch insignia will be parallel to the inside edge of the lapel. See figure 5-8.

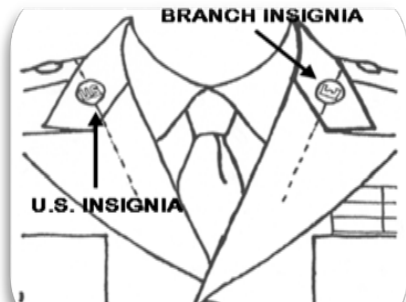


Figure 5-8. U.S and branch insignia, AGSU coat

Shoulder sleeve insignia

The non-subdued SSI will be worn centered on the left sleeve, 1/2 inch below the top of the shoulder seam of the AGSU coat.

Rank insignia

A non-subdued cloth rank insignia with heritage green 564 background is sewn on both sleeves of the AGSU coat and short- and long-sleeved shirts. Males wear the large insignia and females wear the small insignia, centered between the

shoulder seam and the elbow. If unable to be centered, it will be placed 1/2 inch below the SSI.

Service Stripes

Service stripes are worn on the AGSU coat, centered from seam to seam on the outside bottom half of both sleeves. The first stripe is sewn on at an angle of 30 degrees with the lower end inserted in the front inside seam. The upper end of the stripe is inserted in the back seam of the sleeve.

Ribbons

Service ribbons are worn in order of precedence from the wearer's right to left, in one or more rows. No more than four ribbons are worn in any one row.

Service ribbons worn on the AGSU coat will be centered 1/8 inch (3.75 mm) above the left breast pocket, parallel to the floor. The additional row variations are determined by the size of the coat and placement of the lapel. See figure 5-9 for examples of ribbon placement.

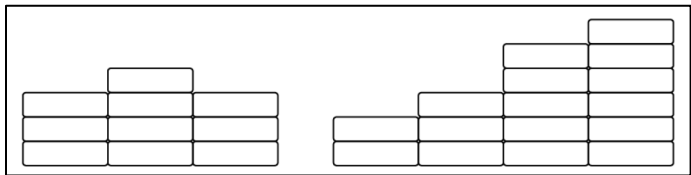


Figure 5-9. Ribbon placement on AGSU coat

Service ribbons worn on the AGSU shirt will be centered 1/4 inch above the top of left pocket for male soldiers. Female soldiers will place ribbons 2 inches below left collar tip, centered on the body, with bottom of ribbons flush with

bottom of regimental distinctive insignia (RDI). No more than two rows consisting of six ribbons total will be worn on the AGSU shirt.

Badges

Soldiers wear special badges above the left pocket, centered 1/4 inch above the ribbons, or in a similar location for uniforms without pockets. A special skill badge may also be worn to the wearer's right of the marksmanship badges.

Marksmanship badges are worn 1/8 inch below the top of the left breast pocket flap or 1/4 inch below the ribbon bar for uniforms without pockets. Soldiers may wear up to three marksmanship badges, worn in order of precedence from the wearer's right, and on the left of any special skill badge.

Have at least 1 inch (25.4 mm) of space between badges if two are worn and evenly spaced if three are worn.

See DA Pamphlet 670-1 for additional badges and the variations of wear.

Regimental and distinctive unit insignia

Distinctive Unit Insignia (DUI)

Soldiers wear the DUI centered on the shoulder loops of the AGSU coat, with an equal distance from the outside shoulder seam to the outside edge of the button with the base of the insignia toward the outside shoulder seam.

Regimental Distinctive Insignia

RDI worn on the AGSU coat will be centered 1/8 inch (3.75 mm) above the top of the right pocket or 1/4 inch above any unit awards.

Male Soldiers wearing the AGSU shirt will place the RDI or the DUI 1/4 inch above the top of the right pocket, centered.

Female Soldiers wearing the AGSU shirt will place the RDI or DUI 2 inches below the right collar tip and 2 inches to the right of the necktie. When the necktie is not worn, the insignia is placed 3 inches from the second button. The insignia is centered on the body and flush with the bottom of ribbons.

Nameplate

The nameplate is worn centered left-to-right on the right pocket flap of the AGSU coat and shirts, parallel to the ground. The nameplate is to be centered between the top of the pocket button and the top of the pocket.

Note: Female Soldiers are to place the nameplate in a comparable position when wearing the AGSU Class B shirt. Personnel may adjust the placement of the nametag, RDI, or DUI up or down to adjust to body composition.

Belts and Buckles

Soldiers are issued the unisex belt in heritage walnut 567, cotton web with oxidized brass tip. The tipped end of the belt passes through the buckle to the wearer's left for male Soldiers and to the wearer's right for female Soldiers. The belt tip will not extend more than 1 inch beyond the first pant loop.

Beret

The beret is worn so that the headband (edge binding) is straight across the forehead, 1 inch (25.4 mm) above the eyebrows.

The flash is positioned over the left eye, and the excess material is draped over to the right ear, so it is extended to at least the top of the ear, and no lower than the middle of the ear.



Figure 5-10. Wear of beret (male and female)

Personnel will cut off the ends of the adjusting ribbon and secure the ribbon knot inside the edge binding at the back of the beret.

When worn properly, the beret is formed to the shape of the head; therefore, Soldiers may not wear hairstyles that cause distortion of the beret.

Note: IET Soldiers will not wear unit insignia on the beret until they arrive at their first unit of assignment.

Clothing Bag Initial Issue



Figure 5-11. Clothing bag initial issue AGSU

5-5. Awards and decorations

Personal decorations and awards

Personal decorations and awards are bestowed upon an individual for his or her act of heroism, specific act of gallantry, or for meritorious service during military or non-military feats.

Collective (unit) citations

A Collective citation is awarded to an operating unit for outstanding performance inside or outside of the U.S. It is worn by those individuals who were members of that unit

during the action or period specified by the award and the individuals who are assigned to the unit until they make a permanent change of station.

Medals commemorative, campaign, and service medals are issued to Soldiers who take part in particular campaigns or periods of service for which a medal is authorized.

Ribbons representing the medals issued are normally worn on the ASUs. Some units, such as the 3rd Infantry (Old Guard) wear the full-size medals on their uniforms.

Ribbons

The *Army Service Ribbon* is awarded to Soldiers who successfully complete OSUT or AIT.



See AR 600-8-22, for more about ribbons.

Marksmanship badges

Marksmanship badges are awarded to individuals who qualify with their individual weapon, because they have demonstrated special proficiency or skill. Marksmanship badges are worn to indicate the individual's proficiency with specific weapons, pistols, and/or rifles and during specified competitions, matches, or practice exercises. You will earn one of the marksmanship badges during BCT.

To earn one of the badges you must achieve the following hits during qualification:

Expert: 36-40

Sharpshooter: 30-35 hits

Marksman: 23-29 hits

The clasp identifies the type of weapon you are qualified on.



Figure 5-12. Marksmanship badges

There are other qualification badges you can compete for during your assignments in the Army.



Chapter 6 – Critical Information Required for BCT/OSUT/AIT

6-1. Rank insignia

Military customs and courtesies dictate that you render the appropriate greeting and salute to officers when you encounter them in the performance of your duties.

This chart can assist you in understanding the Army rank structure. The individual's title reflects the rank of the person. You should never address a person by their pay grade.

Table 6-1. Army rank structure ★

Title	Pay Grade	Rank	Remarks
Private (PVT)	E-1	No Chevron	
Private (PV2)	E-2		
Private First Class (PFC)	E-3		
Specialist (SPC)	E-4		

Table 6-1. Army rank structure (cont.)

NCOs are "the backbone" of the Army. They are responsible for executing a military organization's mission and serve as the principal instructors for training military personnel, so they are prepared to execute those missions.

NCOs are considered the primary link between enlisted personnel and the commissioned officers. Their advice and guidance are particularly important for junior officers, who begin their careers in a position of authority but generally lack practical experience. Sergeants first class and above are considered Senior NCOs.

Title	Pay Grade	Rank	Remarks
Corporal (CPL)	E-4		A SPC recognized with NCO authorities
Sergeant (SGT)	E-5		Team leader
Staff Sergeant (SSG)	E-6		Squad leader or section chief
Sergeant First Class (SFC)	E-7		senior NCO in a platoon

Table 6-1. Army rank structure (cont.)

Title	Pay Grade	Rank	Remarks
Master Sergeant (MSG)	E-8		NCOIC at battalion and brigade
First Sergeant (1SG)	E-8		senior NCO in a company; advisor to the commander
Sergeant Major (SGM)	E-9		Principal advisor on a battalion and higher HQs staff
Command Sergeant Major (CSM)	E-9		Senior enlisted advisor at battalion and higher HQs
Sergeant Major of the Army (SMA)	E-9		Senior NCO in the Army; advisor to the Chief of Staff of the Army

Table 6-1. Army rank structure (cont.)

Warrant Officers are highly specialized technicians and trainers in their career fields. By gaining progressive levels of expertise and leadership, these leaders provide valuable guidance to commanders and subordinate Soldiers in their units.

Title	Pay Grade	Rank	Remarks
Warrant Officer 1 (WO1)	W-1		Company and battalion staffs
Chief Warrant Officer 2 (CW2)	W-2		Company and battalion staffs
Chief Warrant Officer 3 (CW3)	W-3		Company and higher staffs
Chief Warrant Officer 4 (CW4)	W-4		Battalion and higher staffs
Chief Warrant Officer 5 (CW5)	W-5		Brigade and higher staffs

Table 6-1. Army rank structure (cont.)

Commissioned officers are responsible for planning and leading demanding missions while ensuring the welfare, morale and professional development of the Soldiers entrusted to them.

At the captain, lieutenant colonel and colonel level they may serve as commanders for companies, battalions, and brigades. In that capacity, they have disciplinary authorities over you under the Uniform Code of Military Justice.

Title	Pay Grade	Rank	Remarks
2nd Lieutenant (2LT)	O-1		Platoon Leader
1st Lieutenant (1LT)	O-2		Company Executive Officer
Captain (CPT)	O-3		Company Commander; Battalion Staff Officer
Major (MAJ)	O-4		Battalion Executive Officer; Brigade Staff Officer

Table 6-1. Army rank structure (cont.)

Lieutenant Colonel (LTC)	O-5		Battalion Commander; Division Staff Officer
Colonel (COL)	O-6		Brigade Commander; Division Staff Officer
<u>General Officers</u> are commissioned officers who serve as commanders at division-size units and larger, as commanders of installations, and as principal advisors to senior national and state civilian leaders and higher-ranking general officers.			
Title	Pay Grade	Rank	Remarks
Brigadier General (BG)	O-7		
Major General (MG)	O-8		
Lieutenant General (LTG)	O-9		
General (GEN)	O-10		

6-2. Customs and Courtesies

Saluting

The origin of the hand salute is uncertain. Some historians believe it began in late Roman times when assassinations were common. A citizen who wanted to see a public official had to approach with his right hand raised to show that he did not hold a weapon. Knights in armor raised visors with the right hand when meeting a comrade. This practice gradually became a way of showing respect and in early American history sometimes involved removing the hat. By 1820, the motion was modified to touching the hat, and since then has become the hand salute used today.

While in the Army, you salute to show respect toward an officer, flag, or our country. The proper way to salute with or without a weapon is described in Training Circular 3-21.5. See AR 600-25, for when to salute.

Follow these rules:

When you meet someone outside, salute as soon as you recognize that they are an officer, or if you are walking toward the officer, wait until you are about six steps away.

Salute all officers (recognized by rank) in official vehicles identified by special plates or flags.

Salute only on command when in a formation.

If in a group and an officer approaches, the first Soldier to recognize the officer calls the group to attention and all personnel salute.

If you approach an officer while you are double-timing alone, assume quick time, render the hand salute and give the proper greeting. When the salute is returned, execute order arms and resume double-time.

The salute is always initiated by the subordinate and terminated only after acknowledgment by the individual saluted.

Accompany the salute with an appropriate greeting, such as, **"good morning/afternoon, sir /ma'am."**

Salutes are not required to be rendered by or to personnel who are driving or riding in privately owned vehicles.

It is not customary for enlisted personnel to exchange salutes, except in some ceremonial situations.

Never render a salute with a noticeable object in your mouth or right hand.

If you are on detail and an officer approaches, salute if you are in charge of the detail. Otherwise, continue to work.

When spoken to, come to the position of attention while addressing an officer.

Hand salute

The Hand Salute is a one-count movement. The command is "Present, ARMS". The Hand Salute may be executed while marching. When marching, only the Soldier in charge of the formation salutes.



Figure 6-1. Hand salute

When wearing headgear with a visor (with or without glasses), on the command of execution ARMS, raise the right hand sharply, fingers and thumb extended and joined, palm facing down, and place the tip of the right forefinger on the rim of the visor slightly to the right of the right eye. The outer edge of the hand is barely canted downward so that neither the back of the hand nor the palm is clearly visible from the front. The hand and wrist are straight, the elbow inclined slightly forward, and the upper arm horizontal.

When wearing headgear without a visor (or uncovered) and not wearing glasses, execute the Hand Salute in the same manner as previously described, except touch the tip of the right forefinger to the forehead near and slightly to the right of the right eyebrow.

When wearing headgear without a visor (or uncovered) and wearing glasses, execute the Hand Salute in the same manner as previously described, except touch the tip of the right forefinger to that point on the glasses where the temple piece of the frame meets the right edge of the right brow.

Order Arms

Order Arms from the Hand Salute is a one-count movement. The command is “Order, ARMS”. On the command of execution ARMS, return the hand sharply to the side, resuming the Position of Attention.

When reporting or rendering courtesy to an individual, turn the head and eyes toward the person addressed and simultaneously salute. In this situation, the actions are executed without command. The Salute is initiated by the subordinate at the appropriate time (six paces) and terminated upon acknowledgment.

Rendering customs and courtesies to NCOs and Warrant Officers

When addressing an NCO you need to be in the position of Parade Rest. The NCO may direct you to at ease, stand at ease, or rest.

When walking with someone of higher rank, walk on the left side of the individual.

Always greet individuals with the greeting of the day. Be respectful at all times.

Warrant Officers are treated in the same respect as Officers.

Rendering Honor to the Flag

The flag of the U.S. is the symbol of our Nation. The union, white stars on a field of blue, is the honor point of the flag. The union of the flag and the flag itself, when in company with other flags, is always given the honor position, such as, the marching right, the flag's own right, or an observer's left when facing the flag.

The flag of the U.S. is displayed outdoors at all Army installations.

The flag is displayed daily from reveille to retreat. If illuminated, it may be displayed at night during special events or on special occasions deemed appropriate by the commander.

When the flag is raised in the morning or lowered in the evening, stand at attention on the first note of Reveille or "To the Colors." "Colors" refers to the flag of the U.S. and can include the unit flag. Give the required salute. You normally face the flag when saluting unless duty requires you to face in some other direction. At the conclusion of the ceremony, resume your regular duties.

The flag, when flown at half-staff, is hoisted to the peak/top of the flagpole and then lowered to the half-staff position. At the end of the day, the flag is hoisted to the peak before lowered. "Half-staff" means lowering the flag to one-half the distance between the top and bottom of the staff.

Whenever Reveille or To the Colors are played, and you are not in formation and not in a vehicle, come to attention at the first note, face the flag, and give the required salute. If no flag is near, face the music and salute. If you are in formation, salute only on the order "Present arms." If you are in civilian clothing, stand at attention and place your right hand over your heart.

Courtesies

The following rules will help you conduct yourself appropriately in the presence of officers and those senior in rank:

When talking to an Officer or Warrant Officer, stand at attention unless given the order "At ease". When you are dismissed, or when the officer departs, come to attention and salute.

When an officer enters a room, the first Soldier to recognize the officer calls personnel in the room to attention but does not salute. When indoors a Soldier only renders a salute when reporting to the officer or part of a ceremony requiring saluting.

When accompanying a senior, walk on his left.

When an officer enters a dining facility, unless he directs otherwise or a more senior officer is already present, the diners will be given the order "At ease" by the first person who sees the officer. You will remain seated at ease and continue eating unless the officer directs otherwise. If you are directly addressed, you should rise to attention when seated in a chair. If you are seated on a bench, stop eating and sit at attention until the conversation ends.

Note: The officer or NCO may give the directive "Carry on." This means the Soldier or Soldiers should continue with whatever they were doing previously. This same directive is used in many other situations outside of formation, such as in the barracks and break areas.

When outdoors and approached by an NCO, you should stand (when seated) and greet the NCO by saying, "good morning, sergeant," "good afternoon, sergeant," or "good evening, sergeant (last name, if known)."

While going through BCT, you will address all drill sergeants as "Drill Sergeant".

When you report to an officer and you are outdoors, approach the officer, stop about two steps from him/her, and assume the position of attention. Give the proper salute and say, for example, "Sir/Ma'am, Private Smith reports." If you are indoors, use the same procedures as above, except remove your headgear before reporting.

6-3. Bugle Calls

Bugle calls are the musical signals that announce scheduled and certain non-scheduled events on an Army installation. Scheduled calls are prescribed by the installation commander. According to Army customs, bugle calls traditionally signal troops for everything from mealtimes and recall formations, to rendering honors to the nation. Bugle calls normally sound in accordance with the major calls of the day-Reveille, Retreat, and Taps.

Reveille

The call signals the troops to awaken for morning roll call. Most often heard at physical training, it is used to accompany the raising of the National Colors. If outdoors at the first sound of Reveille, you should come to the position of attention and salute, facing the flag or the sound of the music. If not in uniform, come to attention and place your right hand over your heart.

Retreat

The call signals the end of the duty day and lowering of the National Colors. If alone, you should come to attention in the direction of the music or flag. Then, salute when you hear the first note of music after the cannon sounds. If not in

uniform, come to attention and place your right hand over your heart.

Taps

The call signals that unauthorized lights are to be extinguished. It is the last call of the day. If indoors there is no need to stand at attention and salute. The call is also sounded at the completion of a military funeral ceremony. You should come to attention and salute until the music is complete. If not in uniform, come to attention and place your right hand over your heart.

6-4. Drill and Ceremonies

Many drill procedures used by the U.S. Army today were developed during the Revolutionary War. The purpose of the drill then was to instill discipline in American Soldiers. As these Soldiers mastered the art of the drill, they began to work as a team and develop a sense of pride in themselves and in their unit.

In today's Army, the same objectives—teamwork, confidence, pride, alertness, attention to detail, esprit de corps, and discipline are accomplished by drill.

A drill consists of a series of movements by which a unit or individuals are moved in an orderly, uniform manner from one formation or place to another. Units vary in size, but in BCT, you will ordinarily be part of a squad, platoon, company, or battalion.

Strengthen Soldier proficiency with Army customs and courtesies and continue to enculturate pride in discipline within the force.

You will need to know the following drill terms:

Element is an individual, squad, section, platoon, company, or larger unit formed as part of the next higher unit.

Formation is an arrangement of the unit's elements in a prescribed manner such as a line formation in which the elements are side-by-side, or a column formation in which the elements are one behind the other. In a platoon column, the members of each squad are one behind the other with the squads abreast.



Front is a space from one side to the other side of a formation and includes the right and left elements.

Depth is a space from the front to the rear of a formation, including the front and rear elements.

Distance is the space between elements that are one behind the other. The distance between individuals is an (914.4 mm) arm's length, plus 6 inches (152.4 mm), or

approximately 36 inches (914.4 mm) measured from the chest of one Soldier to the back of the Soldier immediately to his front.

Interval is the space between side-by-side elements.

Rank is a line that is only one element in depth.

File is a column that has a front of one element.

Guide is the person responsible for maintaining the prescribed direction and rate of march.

Post is the correct place for an officer or NCO to stand in a prescribed formation.

Head is a column's leading element. Base is the element.

Cadence is a uniform rhythm or number of steps or counts per minute.

Quick Time is a cadence of 120 counts (steps per minute) around which a movement is planned or regulated.

Double Time is a cadence of 180 counts (steps per minute).

Drill commands are oral orders given by your commander or leader, usually in two parts. The preparatory command states the movement to be carried out and gets you ready to execute the order. The command of execution tells when the movement is to be carried out. In the command "Forward, march," the *preparatory* command is "Forward," the command of *execution* is "March."

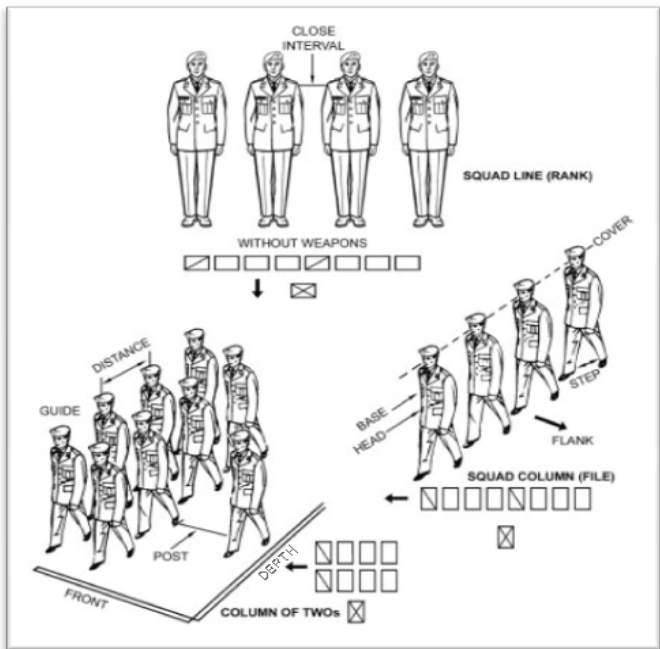


Figure 6-2. Drill and ceremony position

In some commands, the preparatory command and the command of execution are combined. For example, “fall in,” “at ease,” and “rest.” These commands are given without inflection and at a uniformly high pitch and loudness comparable to that of a normal command of execution.

If you are in a group of three or more, marching is required when moving from one location to another.

Most marching movements are a five-step process. This can be simplified into the acronym PICAA:

P-preparatory command

I-intermediate step

C-command of execution

A-action step

A-additional step.

Put simply, the Preparatory command, the command of execution and the action step—executing the movement—are all given or executed when the same foot strikes the marching surface. The Intermediate step and Additional step are executed with the other foot.

Chapter 7 – Physical Readiness

The Holistic Health and Fitness (H2F) System recognizes that Soldier readiness depends on the proper combinations of physical fitness (such as strength, speed, and endurance) and foundational health (such as the cardiovascular, respiratory, immune, and hormonal systems) that are optimized through careful attention to nutritional readiness, mental readiness, spiritual readiness, and sleep readiness. Nutrition—the food, beverages, and supplements in a Soldier's diet—provides the nutrients needed to meet the physical demands of training and combat. Soldiers must also maintain mental readiness—the exceptional mental

flexibility and endurance, outstanding self-initiative and superior judgment required in combat. Spiritual readiness supports individual and collective readiness as Soldiers negotiate challenging moral and ethical situations in training or operational environments. Finally, proper sleep sustains brain function, cognition (thought processing), the immune system, and recovery after physical activity.

7-1. Army Fitness Test (AFT) references

References:

- Field Manual 7-22, Holistic Health and Fitness
- Army Techniques Publication 7-22.01, Holistic Health and Fitness Testing
- Army Techniques Publication 7-22.02, Holistic Health and Fitness Drills and Exercises
- DA Form 705-TEST (Army Fitness Test Scorecard)

The intent of the AFT is to provide an assessment of your physical readiness.

Physical Fitness testing ensures that every Soldier is maintaining a high level of physical performance, regardless of MOS or duty assignment.

The AFT provides a measure of upper and lower body muscular endurance, strength, power, balance, flexibility, and aerobic and anaerobic fitness. It is a performance test that indicates a Soldier's ability to perform Warrior Tasks and Battle Drills. AFT standards are adjusted for age and physiological differences between male and female.

The AFT consists of five events:

1. 3-Repetition Maximum Deadlift (MDL)
2. Hand Release Push-up (HRP)
3. Sprint-Drag-Carry (SDC)
4. Plank (PLK)
5. 2-Mile run (2MR)

The events are performed in that order and on the same day. Rest periods are built into the conduct of the test. All five events start within two hours.

Soldiers in BCT must attain 60 points in each event and an overall score of 300 points to meet AFT minimum standards. You should push yourself to achieve your maximum performance in each event.

Soldiers in AIT and OSUT must also attain a score of at least 60 points on each event and an overall score of at least 300 points to graduate. Combat arms MOS must achieve a total score of 350.

The maximum score a Soldier can attain on the AFT is 500 points. Your goal in BCT should be 65 points in each event and 70 points in each event in AIT/OSUT.

7-2. Army Fitness Test Standards

See AFT standards in tables 7-1, 7-2, 7-3, 7-4, and 7-5.

Table 7-1. 3-Repetition Maximum Deadlift

MDL(lbs)	Age 17-21		Age 22-26		Age 27-31	
Points	M/C	F	M/C	F	M/C	F
100	340	220	350	230	350	240
80	240	150	240	150	240	150
60	150	120	150	120	150	120
50	130	110	130	110	130	110

Table 7-2. Hand Release Push-up

HRP	Age 17-21		Age 22-26		Age 27-31	
Points	M/C	F	M/C	F	M/C	F
100	58	53	61	50	62	48
80	37	23	37	23	37	23
60	15	11	14	11	14	11
50	9	9	9	9	9	9

Table 7-3. Spring-Drag-Carry

SDC	Age 17-21		Age 22-26		Age 27-31	
Points	M/C	F	M/C	F	M/C	F
100	1:29	1:55	1:30	1:55	1:30	1:55
80	1:53	2:28	1:53	2:29	1:55	2:29
60	2:28	3:15	2:31	3:15	2:32	3:15
50	2:38	3:25	2:41	3:25	2:42	3:25

Table 7-4. Plank

PLK	Age 17-21		Age 22-26		Age 27-31	
Points	M/ C	F	M/ C	F	M/ C	F
100	3:40	3:40	3:35	3:35	3:30	3:30
80	2:35	2:35	2:30	2:30	2:25	2:25
60	1:30	1:30	1:25	1:25	1:20	1:20
50	1:25	1:25	1:20	1:20	1:15	1:15

Table 7-5. 2-Mile Run

2MR	Age 17-21		Age 22-26		Age 27-31	
Points	M/ C	F	M/ C	F	M/ C	F
100	13:22	16:00	13:25	15:30	13:25	15:30
80	17:13	19:30	17:18	19:25	17:21	19:45
60	19:57	22:55	19:45	22:45	19:45	22:45
50	20:25	23:24	20:13	23:14	20:13	23:14

Chapter 8 – Health and Safety

8-1. Performance Nutrition

The Army's Holistic Health and Fitness System (H2F) highlights *Nutritional Readiness* as a key component to Soldier performance (FM 7-22). Nutritional readiness is the

ability to recognize, select, and consume the necessary foods and fluids to meet the physical and nonphysical demands of any duty or combat position, accomplish the mission, and come home healthy.

Fuel your body for optimal performance

As a Soldier athlete, you are expected to achieve and maintain a high level of fitness and readiness. Fitness is not only achieved by your training, but also how you fuel (with food) and hydrate (with fluid) your body. Fueling with performance *limiting* foods (such as “junk” foods or most vending machine items, regular sodas, energy drinks, most fast-food options, fried foods, etc.) leads to mental and physical fatigue and could contribute to injuries and illnesses.

Optimal fueling requires a little knowledge, a little discipline, and a whole lot of dedication to caring for the Army’s most important weapons system—YOU!

Fueling with the right amount of carbohydrates, protein, and healthful fats promotes energy, endurance, stamina, and muscle growth. Benefits of proper fueling include:

- Maintaining a lean body composition
- Decreasing post-exercise muscle soreness
- Stronger and healthier muscles

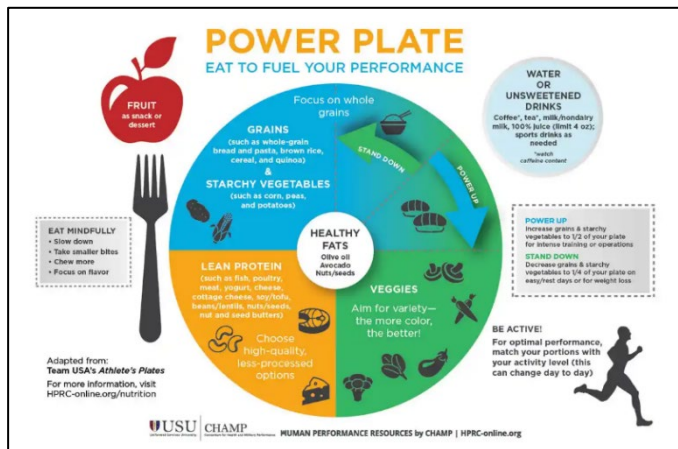


Figure 8-1. Power Plate performance nutrition guidance

General guidelines are to have:

- $\frac{1}{2}$ of your plate full of a variety of fruits and vegetables
- $\frac{1}{4}$ of your plate composed of complex carbohydrates (grains and starchy vegetables)
- $\frac{1}{4}$ of your plate in the form of lean protein

Portion sizes will vary based on your daily energy (or calorie) needs and performance goals.

To create a strong performance eating pattern, keep these concepts in mind:

Eat regular meals and snacks.

- Don't skip meals
- Plan ahead

Eat a variety of fruits and vegetables.

They are excellent sources of vitamin C, beta-carotene, potassium, magnesium, and many other vitamins, minerals, and other health-protective substances. They add to the strong carbohydrate foundation for your performance eating pattern. Fruits are rich in fiber, potassium, and many other vitamins, especially vitamin C. The nutrients found in fruits and vegetables can aid in recovery after exercise and improve healing.

- Fresh fruit and veggies of all colors
- Canned, jarred, and frozen fruits and veggies
- Dried fruit

Choose more whole grains (at least half your grains should be whole)

They are the primary fuel for your muscles and brain, protect against muscle fatigue, and can reduce problems with constipation if high in fiber.

- Whole-wheat breads, bagels, tortillas, pastas.
- Brown rice, oatmeal.
- High-fiber, low-sugar cereals, and granola/snack bars

Incorporate lean protein and dairy sources.

These foods provide the amino acids you need to build and repair muscles. The calcium and vitamin D dairy and other foods help to maintain strong teeth and bones.

- Low-fat milk/chocolate milk (or soy milk).
- Low-fat Greek yogurt.
- Beef jerky, lean meat, fish, poultry.
- Eggs.
- Beans.

Add healthful sources of fat.

- Nuts, seeds, and nut butters.
- Avocados.
- Plant-based oils (for example, olive and canola oil).

Consume alcohol in moderation.

- Men – up to two drinks per day.
- Women – up to one drink per day.

Use caution with caffeine intake.

Caffeine is found in coffee, tea, energy drinks, soda, and dietary supplements.

Eat at least 3-5 different kinds of nutrient-dense foods at each meal. The more types or varieties of food you eat, the more vitamins, minerals, and other nutrients you consume.

For Soldiers to perform optimally throughout their careers in assignments with varying levels of mental and physical difficulty, they must place as much emphasis on nutrition to support performance as they do on physical and mental health. Remember: You can't "out-exercise" poor dietary choices.

Go for Green® (G4G) is a Department of Defense (DoD) performance-nutrition program that can be found in the Army's Warrior Restaurants. G4G makes it easy to find and choose high-performance fuel by labeling items **Green** (high-performance fuel), **Yellow** (moderate-performance fuel), and **Red** (low-performance fuel).

Stay hydrated

Fluid needs vary greatly from person to person, and depend on intensity of work, level of heat stress, and sweat rates.

The first step in hydration is to drink fluids and eat foods high in water content throughout the day.

Cool water is the beverage of choice for maintaining hydration. Recommended fluid intake ranges from 2 to 5 quarts (64-160 ounces) per day. For reference, a canteen holds 1 quart of fluid, an issued hydration pack holds ~3 quarts.

- Drink regularly or whenever possible during exercise, training, and operations. Drink 16–32 ounces of fluid every 60 minutes during activity to stay hydrated.
- Performance declines with slight dehydration.

- To rehydrate (replace fluids) after exercise, drink liquids and eat foods that contain fluids. Consume about 20–24 ounces of fluid for every pound of weight you lost.
- Drinking too much plain water or not consuming enough sodium can lead to hyponatremia (low sodium levels in your blood), a potentially serious condition.

Electrolytes control the fluid balance of the body and are important in muscle contraction, among many other essential functions. Electrolytes (sodium, potassium, calcium, magnesium, and chloride) are found in food and fluids. The loss of sodium and potassium in sweat can be quite high during prolonged physical activity, especially in warm weather. It's important to choose foods and beverages that contain sodium and other electrolytes to promote faster and more complete recovery. Drinking too much plain water or not consuming enough sodium can result in *hyponatremia* (low sodium levels in your blood), which requires immediate medical attention to reduce risk of serious illness or death.

Hyponatremia typically occurs during physical activities of longer duration. Symptoms, which can be severe, include headache, vomiting, swollen hands and feet, fatigue, confusion, disorientation, and breathing problems. Keep in mind that some symptoms of hyponatremia are similar to the symptoms of dehydration, so be mindful of how much and how often you drink fluids. Source: *Warfighter Nutrition Guide*, May 2022. Human Performance Resources by

CHAMP, <https://www.hprc-online.org/nutrition/warfighter-nutrition-guide>.

Sports drinks are an option for sodium replacement if you fail to consume enough food during training and/or not acclimated to the heat*. Avoid putting sports drinks in your wearable hydration system, as this will increase the risk of harmful bacteria or mold growth.

**Note:* Heat acclimatization may take up to 21 days or more for untrained Soldiers.

How Do You Know if You Are Hydrated?

The simplest way to determine if you are adequately replacing the fluid lost through sweat is to check the color and quantity of your urine. During your first void (or urination) of the day, if you see that your urine is dark, you need to drink more fluids or eat more foods with a high-water content. *Recommended fluids:* water, sports drinks, 100% fruit juice, milk, milk alternatives (soy, almond). *Recommended foods:* fruits and vegetables, soup, yogurt

Be smart about energy drinks

Energy drinks are not the same as sports drinks and should never be consumed for hydration — cool, plain water should always be a first choice. Energy drinks generally contain large quantities of caffeine and may contain other ingredients, most of which do absolutely nothing to enhance performance or health. Also, the large quantities of caffeine can aggravate dehydration, and may lead to increased anxiety, upset stomach, shakiness, headaches, and sleep issues.

These potential side effects can reduce your ability to perform, NOT enhance it. Instead of reaching for energy drinks, it's best to feed your body energy throughout the day:

- Snack on carbohydrates and energy-rich foods such as dried fruits, nuts, trail mix, a commercial sports bar or low-fat chocolate milk.
- Drink cool, plain water frequently, even if you aren't thirsty.

Dietary supplements

Many Soldiers use dietary supplements to improve performance, increase muscle mass, enhance energy, accelerate recovery, increase alertness, boost their immune system, and improve joint function. However, dietary supplements are not tested or approved by the Food and Drug Administration prior to placement on the market, are often unnecessary, and can be dangerous and expensive.

Although some dietary supplements can offer some benefits, others might be unsafe or contaminated with drugs, controlled substances, or other ingredients not listed on the label. The most tainted dietary supplements are those marketed for:

- Bodybuilding
- Weight loss
- Sexual enhancement

Dietary supplements come in several forms—tablets, capsules, soft gels, gel caps, powders, energy bars, gummies, and liquids—with an even greater variety of

ingredients. Be informed before putting them in your body!

Before you take a supplement, ask yourself:

1. Do I really need it?
2. What do I expect it to do?
3. Does it work?
4. Is it safe?
5. What's in it?
6. Does it contain a proprietary blend?
7. Was it tested by a third party?

Choose food first!

Food should be your first choice to help meet your goals because supplements:

- Often are unnecessary
- Are not approved by FDA before being sold
- Can be dangerous
- Can be expensive
- Are not substitutes for a healthy, balanced eating plan

Whole foods are food products that are processed or refined as little as possible and are free from additives or other artificial substances. They are a natural powerhouse of nutrients such as protein, carbohydrates, vitamins, and minerals that promote energy, muscle growth, performance, and healthy weight maintenance. Whole foods are superior to supplements and should be your first choice, regardless of your goals. What's more, whole foods taste better, are safer, and generally cost less! If you decide to use a

supplement, be informed, and visit **Operation Supplement Safety** at <https://www.opss.org/>.

OPSS is a DoD-wide initiative to educate the military community about dietary supplements and provide the tools to be informed supplement users—or non-users. The OPSS website provides easy access to updated materials and databases for you to stay informed and make healthy dietary supplement choices.

8-2. Sleep

The disciplined practices in *sleep*, *activity*, and *nutrition* comprise the Army's "performance triad." By following the habits outlined below you maximize performance and avoid illness and injury.

Make Sleep A Priority - Sleep is a biological need for brain functioning and is critical to sustain the mental abilities required for success in BCT and advanced individual training. Soldiers require a minimum of 7-8 hours of sleep every 24 hours.

In BCT, you can receive at least 7 hours of continuous sleep per night (unless you are scheduled for duty such as access control guard/fireguard or charge of quarter's runner).

During field training, the length of the training day, and time for sleep will vary based on training requirements; however, your commander will ensure that the schedule allows sufficient time for sleep during field training.

The MOST IMPORTANT THING YOU MUST REMEMBER:

When you can sleep, do it. Insufficient sleep presents a risk to mission success. Sleep deprived Soldiers are likely to make mission critical and sometimes fatal errors.

The demanding nature of military operations often creates situations in which obtaining enough sleep on a regular basis is difficult or impossible. Such chronic, insufficient sleep (anything less than 7-8 hours per 24 hours) produces a sleep debt – a chronic state of increased sleep need that is characterized by impaired performance and readiness.

The only way to eliminate the debt is to obtain sleep (just closing your eyes and resting is not the same as sleeping/napping). As a Soldier you must make sleep a priority!

When you can rest or sleep, do it.

8-3. Activity

During BCT you will obviously maintain a high level of activity. However, once you graduate from AIT or OSUT, you have much more control over your level of activity. You will need recreational-type activities to maintain your optimum performance; Army physical readiness training and the other high-physical demands of your duties will not provide all the physical activity you need.

Physical activity is more than just “exercise” or “working out”- it’s living an active lifestyle. Whether it’s walking the dog, doing yard work, or playing with your kids, regular movement throughout the day inspires positive health outcomes over time.

Physical activity improves health in the following ways:

- Lowers risk of some chronic diseases and conditions such as type 2 diabetes, high blood pressure, stroke, and cancer (for example, breast and colon).
- Aids weight loss and prevents weight gain.
- Helps manage stress and may reduce depression.
- Strengthens bones, muscles, and joints.
- Boosts confidence and self-esteem.

Amount and types of physical activity. To receive positive health outcomes, you need at least:

- 150 minutes of moderate-intensity aerobic activity per week. 150 minutes is also: 2 hours and 30 minutes per week OR 30 minutes a day for 5 days OR 10 minutes of activity 3 times a day for 5 days.
- 2 days of muscle strengthening activities (like weight/resistance band training, calisthenics, and yoga).
- 10,000 steps during your everyday routine. *Note:* 10,000 steps are approximately 5 miles. An inactive person may only average 1,000 to 3,000 steps a day, or about one mile. Persons who walk less than this in a normal day should add walking to their routines.

Save time by bumping up the intensity. Perform 75 minutes of vigorous-intensity activities per week (jogging, swimming laps, or hiking uphill).

- Pick activities you enjoy. Moderate-intensity activities include brisk walking, doubles tennis, golf, and leisure biking.
- Invite Family, friends, and fellow Soldiers to join you. Take a fitness class, join a recreation league, sign up for a 5K run/walk, or start a walking group in your neighborhood.

8-4. Basic Hygiene Principles

In addition to Army training, personal hygiene plays a crucial role in your overall physical readiness as a strong, productive Soldier. There are numerous health concerns that can arise if you do not conduct proper personal hygiene at home and in field environments.

- **Avoid communicable diseases**
- **Bathe daily with soap and water**
- **Wash your hair at least twice a week**
- **Soldiers must be clean-shaven when in uniform or civilian clothes while on duty, or with temporary exemptions for medical reasons and permanent exemptions for religious accommodation. Army Directive 2025-13, Facial Hair Grooming Standards, 07JUL2025 prohibits permanent shaving profiles. Avoid sharing combs and razors**
- **Avoid contact with people who are ill**
- **Always cough into your arm**

- **Clean your hand frequently to avoid spreading/receiving germs**
- **Brush your teeth 2-3 times a day, for 2-3 minutes, with fluoride toothpaste**
- **Floss once a day using 28 inches of floss**
- **Alternate boots daily**
- **Cut toenails straight across, short and square, every two weeks**
- **Minimize blisters by wearing proper fitting boots and tight fitting, clean, dry socks free of excessive wear**
- **Always wear your earplugs correctly to protect your hearing when around loud noises such as generators and weapons/ranges**
- **Protect yourself against the effects of heat, cold, and insects**

8-5. Ready and Resilient

Soldiers must cope with adversity, perform well in stressful situations, and learn to thrive in stressful environments.

The ready and resilient Fitness program is designed to build resilience and enhance the performance of the Army Family – Soldiers, their Families, and Army Civilians – through hands-on training and online self-development tools.

Resilient individuals enhance Army performance and readiness. Resilience is the ability to grow and thrive in the face of challenges and bounce back from adversity.

The goal of ready and resilient Family Fitness is to increase your resilience and enhance your performance by developing and strengthening five dimensions of strength.

1. **Social** strength refers to developing and maintaining trusted, valued relationships and friendships that are personally fulfilling and foster good communication, including a comfortable exchange of ideas, views, and experiences.

2. **Emotional** strength means approaching life's challenges in a positive, optimistic way by demonstrating self-control, stamina, and good character with your choices and actions.

3. **Family** strength is about being a part of a Family unit that is safe, supportive, loving, and provides the resources needed for all members to live in a healthy and secure environment.

4. **Spiritual** strength refers to one's purpose, values, beliefs, identity, and life vision. These elements, which define the essence of a person, enable one to build inner strength, make meaning of experiences, behave ethically, persevere through challenges, and be resilient when faced with adversity. An individual's spirituality draws upon personal, philosophical, psychological, and/or religious teachings, and forms the basis of their character.

5. **Physical** strength is about performing and excelling in physical activities that require aerobic fitness, endurance, strength, healthy body composition, and flexibility derived through exercise, nutrition, and training. The physical dimension also encompasses the Office of the Surgeon

General (OTSG) Performance Triad initiative of sleep, activity, and nutrition to improve personal and unit performance, resilience, and readiness.

8-6. Chaplains

The chaplain is responsible for providing spiritual support to every Soldier in the unit. Although chaplains are part of a particular denomination, their mission is to ensure the spiritual needs of every Soldier are met. Each battalion in the Army has its own chaplain (normally a CPT). The chaplains and their assistants form the Unit Ministry Team.

Chaplains hold weekly services (while in garrison and in the field), are available for individual counseling, and are one of the few members of the military who retain the privilege of confidentiality. The chaplain also plays a key role in helping promote programs, such as suicide prevention.

In the BCT/OSUT/AIT environment, they are of value in helping Soldiers succeed under difficult and stressful conditions. They assist the commander in teaching, displaying, and instilling the Army Values and with maintaining high morale within the unit.

8-7. Risk management

Every Soldier, regardless of rank, is faced with making decisions. You will be challenged to make informed decisions that consider both risk and potential benefit. Your decisions not only affect you, but also your team, family, and friends.

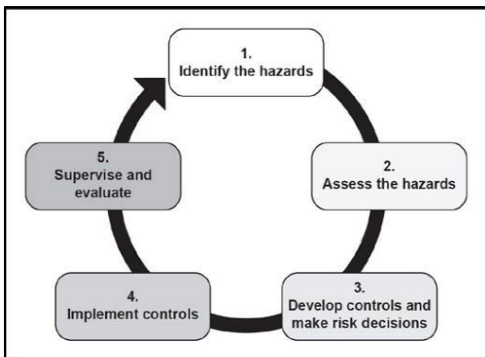


Figure 8-2. Risk management cycle

The Army uses a process called Risk Management to help make those decisions. Army Techniques Publication 5-19, *Risk Management* is the Army's doctrinal manual for risk management.

The decision-making process doesn't just apply in combat; it applies to everything you do on or off duty. The goal is to preserve the Army's ability to fight and win by avoiding unnecessary risk and making informed decisions at every level. The Army's Risk Management process is a logical approach to risk-associated decision making that helps you make smart risk decisions and reduce the possibility of losses.

As you progress throughout your career, you will learn more about the risk management process. A few of the hazards you may encounter during IET include:

- Hot weather injury

- Cold weather injury
- Weapon-related hazards
- Environmental hazards (insects, animals, poisonous plants, etc.)

QR code to the H2F website



Chapter 9 – Discipline

The Army is subject to military law and the laws of our government, and we strive to live as law-abiding Soldiers in whatever we do and wherever we go.

Discipline is the practice of our profession in the conduct of duty, ethically, effectively, and efficiently meeting standards while striving for excellence.

Military discipline is founded upon self-discipline, respect for properly constituted authority, and embracing the professional Army Ethic with its supporting individual values. Military discipline is instilled through positive leadership, reinforcing the regulatory standards for personnel, and the training readiness standards for individual and collective tasks, together, resulting in a mental attitude about proper conduct and obedience to lawful military authority.

While military discipline is the result of effective training, it is affected by every feature of military life. It is manifested in individuals and units by:

- Cohesion, bonding, and a spirit of teamwork.
- Smartness of appearance and action.
- Cleanliness and maintenance of dress, equipment, and quarters.
- Deference to seniors and mutual respect between senior and subordinate personnel.
- Prompt and willing execution of both the letter and the spirit of the legal orders of their lawful commanders.
- Just treatment for all Soldiers, regardless of race, color, sex, national origin, religion, and sexual orientation.

The Rules

There are three basic rules you should follow:

- Follow Army regulations and the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ).
- Take responsibility for your actions.
- Set the example, do what is right even when no one is watching.

Standards of Conduct:

- Decisions and actions remain consistent with the Army Values, laws, and regulations.

- Strict obedience and prompt execution of the legal orders of their lawful seniors.
- Doing what is right even when no one is watching and choosing the hard right over the easy wrong.
- Accepting responsibility for your actions.

9-1. Non-Punitive Corrective Action

Nonpunitive corrective measures are the primary tools for teaching proper standards of conduct and performance and do not constitute punishment, nor are they required as a first step toward nonjudicial punishment. Included among nonpunitive measures are denial of pass or other privileges, counseling, administrative reduction in grade, administrative reprimands and admonitions, extra training, bar to continued service, and military occupational specialty (MOS) reclassification.

One of the most effective nonpunitive corrective measures is extra training or instruction. For example, if Soldiers appear in an improper uniform, they are required to correct it immediately; if they do not maintain their government housing area properly, they must correct the deficiency in a timely manner. If Soldiers have training deficiencies, they are required to take extra training or instruction in subjects related to the shortcoming. If a Soldier demonstrates minor acts of indiscipline, physical exercise may be an acceptable form of corrective training.

Corrective measures may be taken after normal duty hours. Such measures assume the nature of training or instruction, not punishment. Corrective training should continue only

until the training deficiency is overcome. Authority to use it is part of the inherent powers of command.

Uniform Code of Military Justice

Soldiers are subject not only to the laws of the United States and host countries, but also the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ). The UCMJ is a federal law that applies to all Soldiers in an active-duty status, 24 hours a day and 7 days a week, anywhere the world. Violations of Army regulations, state and federal laws, and the orders of superiors may constitute criminal conduct punishable under the UCMJ.

The UCMJ enumerates a wide range of criminal offenses (“Articles”) ranging from traditional crimes such as assault, theft, driving while intoxicated, disorderly conduct, murder, and sexual assault; to military specific crimes such as violating a regulation, disrespect/insubordination, fraternization, failure to pay debts, sexual harassment, and any conduct that is prejudicial to good order and discipline and/or of a nature to bring discredit to the service. The UCMJ also establishes the various types of courts and sets forth the procedures to be followed in the administration of military justice. You can find the UCMJ in Appendix 2 of the U.S. Manual for Court Martial or in Title 10, United States Code (USC), Sections 801-940.

UCMJ Article 15 authorizes commanders to impose non-judicial punishment (NJP) for minor offenses when non-punitive administrative corrective measures are inadequate due to the nature of the minor offense or because of the servicemember’s service record. Proceedings under Article 15 are not adversarial criminal prosecutions. This means that the hearing is not like a courtroom hearing (i.e., a court-

martial). Neither the Soldier nor their spokesperson (or retained lawyer) may examine or cross-examine witnesses unless allowed by the commander and the commander is not bound by the formal rules of evidence.

The UCMJ also authorizes commanders to convene court martials. Courts-martial are adversarial proceedings. That is, lawyers representing the government and the accused present facts and arguments most favorable to each side. In doing so, they follow the rules of procedure and evidence. The judge decides questions of law. The court-martial members apply the law and decide questions of fact.

UCMJ: Non-judicial punishment

Non-judicial punishment (NJP) is generally used to address “minor” offenses related to intentional disregard of or failure to comply with standards of military conduct.

One of the purposes of NJP is to educate, correct, and reform. It promotes positive behavior changes in Soldiers without the stigma of a court-martial conviction.

Whether an offense is minor is within the discretion of the commander and depends on several factors including the nature of the offense and the circumstances surrounding its commission; the offender’s age, rank, duty assignment, military record, and experience; and the maximum sentence impossible for the offense if tried by court martial. Common IET offenses punishable under Article 15 include insubordination, disrespect, fraternization, failure to report at the appointed time, and simple assault.

The imposing commander will ensure that the Soldier is notified of the commander’s intention to dispose of the matter pursuant to the provisions of UCMJ, Article 15, the

maximum punishment, and the right to examine evidence, seek counsel, present witnesses/evidence, and the right to demand a court-martial instead.

The UCMJ, Article 15 proceedings are not adversarial in nature. Soldiers may request an open or closed hearing. The Soldier is allowed to personally present matters in defense, extenuation, or mitigation in the presence of the imposing commander, except when appearance is prevented by the unavailability of the commander or by extraordinary circumstances.

Punishment may include extra duty, restriction, forfeitures of pay, reduction in rank, oral or written reprimand, and correctional custody. Whether to impose punishment and the nature of the punishment are the sole decisions of the imposing commander. Soldiers may choose to submit an appeal of the Article 15 findings and punishment to the next higher commander.

UCMJ: Court-martial

Courts-martial, in general, are adversarial trial proceedings. At a court-martial, a trial counsel represents the government, and a defense counsel represents the accused. The court-martial system consists of three types of courts-martial: a summary court-martial, a special court-martial, and a general court-martial. In determining the appropriate type of court-martial, a convening authority considers a variety of factors including the interests of good order and discipline, and the severity of the charged offense(s).

A summary court-martial (SCM) is a court composed of one officer who may or may not be a lawyer. The SCM handles

minor crimes of enlisted Soldiers only and has simple procedures. The maximum punishment, which depends upon the rank of the accused, is limited to confinement for one month (for E4s and below), forfeiture of two-thirds pay for one month, and reduction in grade. An SCM may not try an accused against their will. If the accused objects, the SCM authority may consider trial by a higher court-martial. The accused does not have the right to military counsel at an SCM, although he or she will see a trial defense attorney before the court-martial. An SCM is a non-criminal forum which means that a finding of guilty does not constitute a criminal conviction.

A special court-martial (SPCM) can try all Soldiers and consists of a military judge, four panel members (unless the accused chooses to be tried by a military judge alone), a trial counsel, and a defense counsel. The maximum sentence is a bad conduct discharge (BCD), confinement for twelve months, forfeiture of two-thirds pay per month for twelve months, and reduction to the lowest enlisted grade. If a BCD is adjudged, the accused has a right to an automatic appeal to the Army Court of Criminal Appeals. A Convening Authority may also send a Soldier to judge only SPCM that is not authorized to adjudge a punitive discharge with a maximum punishment of confinement not to exceed six months, and forfeitures of pay not to exceed six months.

A general court-martial (GCM) tries cases over all Soldiers for the most serious offenses. It consists of a military judge, twelve members in a capital/death case and eight members in a non-capital case (unless the accused elects to be tried by a military judge alone), a trial counsel, and a defense counsel. Unless waived by the accused, a formal

preliminary hearing (an “Article 32” hearing) must occur before a GCM may try the case. The GCM may adjudge the most severe sentences authorized by law, including the death penalty.

9-2. Military Equal Opportunity (MEO) Policy

The MEO program ensures an Army-wide, concentrated effort to maximize human potential and to ensure fair treatment for all persons based solely on merit, fitness, and capability in support of readiness.

The Army’s MEO program emphasizes fair and equal treatment for military personnel, and civilian employees without regard to race, color, religion, sex, or national origin. This policy applies on and off post, extends to Soldiers, civilian employees, and includes working, living, and recreational environments.

Complaint process

The MEO complaint processing system addresses grievances that allege unlawful discrimination or unfair treatment based on race, color, sex, national origin, religion, or sexual orientation and harassment, which includes hazing, bullying, and other discriminatory harassment.

Always attempt to resolve problems at the lowest possible level in an organization.

All submitted complaints are investigated. Personnel found in violation of the MEO Policy are subject to punishment under the UCMJ.

Within reason, Soldiers and other individuals are encouraged to attempt resolution of any complaints by

directly addressing the alleged offender, or by informing other appropriate officials about the offensive behavior or unfair treatment.

Knowingly submitting a false complaint (a complaint containing information or allegations that a Soldier knows to be false) may be punishable under UCMJ.

Soldiers must submit only legitimate complaints and should exercise caution against frivolous or reckless allegations.

Types of MEO complaints

The Army has three types of complaints within the MEO complaint process: anonymous, informal, and formal.

An anonymous complaint is one in which the complainant remains unidentified. It may be handled as either an informal or a formal complaint based on the Commander's discretion. Actions taken regarding anonymous complaints will depend upon the extent of information provided in the anonymous complaint.

An *informal complaint* is any complaint that a Soldier does not wish to file in writing via DA Form 7279 (Equal Opportunity and Harassment Complaint).

Informal complaints may be resolved by the complainant directly with the assistance of another unit member, the commander, or another person in the complainant's chain of command.

Typically, those issues that may be taken care of informally and can be resolved through discussion, problem identification, and clarification of the issues. An informal complaint is still tracked in the MEO database.

A *formal complaint* is one that a complainant files in writing using a DA Form 7279 and swears to the accuracy of the information.

Formal complaints require specific actions, are subject to timelines, and require documentation of the actions taken.

Alternative measures:

Although handling MEO complaints through the chain of command is strongly encouraged, this is not the only channel available to Soldiers. Should a Soldier feel uncomfortable in filing a complaint with the chain of command, or should the complaint be against a member of the chain of command, there are several alternative agencies through which a complaint can be made.

The following agencies are frequently used:

- MEO professional
- Chaplain
- Provost Marshal
- Legal Assistance
- Housing Referral Office
- Inspector General
- MEO Hotline

Inspector General (IG): Serves as the eyes, ears, voice, and conscience of the commander. The IG performs four basic functions: teaching and training; inspections; assistance, and investigations. Providing the commander impartial fact findings to improve the Army and support the Chain of Command.

Right to appeal: If a subject or complainant perceives an investigation failed to reveal all relevant facts, or if actions taken on their behalf are perceived as insufficient to resolve the complaint, they have the right to appeal to the next higher commander.

The complainant may not appeal the action taken against the perpetrator, if any is taken.

9-3. Policy on relationships between Soldiers:

Army policy imposes many restrictions on senior-subordinate relationships. These restrictions are necessary to maintain good order and discipline and to protect the integrity of the chain of command and the welfare of Soldiers. See AR 600-32 and TRADOC Regulation 350-6, for more detailed policy on prohibited relationships and activities.

In general, Soldiers of different grades in the Army must be cognizant that their interactions do not create an actual or clearly predictable perception of undue familiarity between an officer and an enlisted Soldier, or between an NCO and a junior enlisted Soldier. Army regulations prohibit any relationship between officers and enlisted Soldiers and NCOs and junior enlisted Soldiers which results in the following effects:

- Compromise, or appear to compromise, the integrity of supervisory authority or the chain of command.
- Cause actual or perceived partiality or unfairness.
- Involve, or appear to involve, the improper use of rank or position for personal gain.

- Are, or are perceived to be, exploitative in nature.
- Create an actual or clearly predictable adverse impact on discipline, authority, morale, or the command's ability to accomplish its mission.

Certain types of relationships between officers and enlisted Soldiers or between NCOs and junior enlisted Soldiers are automatically prohibited. These types of relationships include dating, shared living accommodations (other than due to operational necessity), engagement in intimate or sexual relationships, ongoing business relationships and gambling.

Army policy imposes additional restrictions on inappropriate relations between recruiters and prospects, applicants, and/or recruits and between permanent party personnel (including BCT/OSUT/AIT training cadre, regardless of rank or position) and BCT/OSUT/AIT Soldiers/trainees.

The following relationships and activities are prohibited between permanent party personnel training cadre and trainees:

- Developing, attempting to develop, or conducting a personal, intimate, or sexual relationship. These relationships include, but are not limited to, dating, handholding, kissing, embracing, caressing, and engaging in sexual activities. Prohibited personal, intimate, or sexual relationships include those relationships conducted in person; through a third person; or via cards, letters, emails, telephone calls, instant messaging, video, photographs, social media, social networking, and any other means of communication.

- Using rank or position, threats, pressure, or promise of return of favors or favorable treatment to gain sexual favors or make any sexual advances or seek or accept any sexual advances or favors.
- Entering a private dwelling or privately owned vehicle. Exceptions are permitted for official business when the safety or welfare of the trainee is at risk but must be immediately reported to the chain of command.
- Providing/accepting alcohol or consuming alcohol together. This prohibition does not apply to the practice of participation in religious services, rites, or rituals.
- Attending social gatherings, clubs, bars, theaters, or similar establishments on a personal social basis.
- Gambling or lending money to, borrowing money from, or otherwise become indebted.
- Soliciting or accepting donations.
- Hiring or employing a trainee, in an unofficial or personal capacity, for any reason.
- Offering or accepting personal goods, in an unofficial or personal capacity, for storage for any reason.
- Participating in closed-door discussions. Doors will remain open during meetings except when another person at least 18 years of age or older is present; it is necessary to protect personally identifiable, sensitive, or confidential information (these closed-door sessions will be short in duration); or the design of the office is such that the door opens to a public area where the office is left unprotected from the elements or allows unwanted

public interaction. In these cases, the door is left unlocked and clearly marked that it is open for business and visitors are welcome.

These prohibitions apply from the first contact between a recruit and recruiter through entry-level training and for 6 months after the trainee completes entry-level training. This list of inappropriate behavior is not all-inclusive.

Finally, TRADOC policy imposes additional restrictions on relations between trainees to maintain good order and discipline necessary to accomplish training requirements, which include, but is not limited to the following:

- Intimate and sexual relationships including dating, handholding, embracing, caressing, kissing, touching, massaging, or fondling of a sexual nature, engaging in sexual intercourse, or sodomy.
- Use of sexually explicit, suggestive, or obscene language or gestures directed towards, or with respect to another Soldier in BCT, OSUT or AIT.
- Entry into the living quarters, latrines, or other areas designated for the exclusive use of Soldiers of the opposite sex, unless required by training mission or official duties, or for health or safety emergencies.

However, language or socializing of a non-sexual, non-harassing nature between IET Soldiers is not prohibited if the interaction is based on the esprit de corps and enthusiasm generated by the IET mission and the professional development associated with IET.

Fraternization

The Army's fraternization policy prohibits unprofessional relationships between officer and enlisted personnel regardless of their service. Leaders and subordinates of any kind and NCOs and junior Soldiers. This policy applies to all personnel, regardless of sex.

Violations of Army's fraternization and improper relationships policy may be punished under Article 92 and/or Article 134 of the UCMJ, as a violation of a lawful general regulation or prejudicial to good order and discipline.

Categories of personal relationships may include:

- Dating
- Shared living accommodations
- Engaging in intimate or sexual relations
- Business enterprises
- Commercial solicitations
- Gambling or borrowing
- Writing personal letters
- Text messages
- Emails (Unrelated to the training mission)
- Personal telephone conversations (unrelated to the training mission)
- Friending through social media sites

Improper relationships ★

There are two major categories of illegal associations: relationships between permanent party members and BCT/OSUT/AIT Soldiers (Cadre-Trainee) and relationships between BCT/OSUT/AIT Soldiers (Trainee-Trainee).

Any relationship between permanent party personnel (command team, drill sergeants, and Civilians) and Trainee Soldiers not required by the training mission is prohibited.

There are no consensual relationships between cadre/permanent party - Trainee or between Trainee-Trainee during BCT/OSUT/AIT.

DD Form 2982. Trainers will sign DD Form 2982, (Recruiter/Trainer Prohibited Activities Acknowledgment), a form with explicit and strict command guidance that acknowledges the trainer's understanding and responsibilities regarding the policies prohibiting inappropriate behaviors and relations outlined in DOD instructions. This form will be retained in the trainer's record while they are assigned to the training duty and will be revalidated annually.

DD Form 2983. After receiving the training on the policies stated in the DOD instructions all Soldiers/Trainees will sign DD Form 2983 (Recruit/Trainee Prohibited Activities Acknowledgment), acknowledging their understanding and responsibilities. This form is retained in the Soldier's file until they detach from the training command or school to which they are assigned or attached.

9-4. SHARP

A Soldier in the U.S. Army *stands strong* - a member of a band of brothers and sisters bound together by common moral purpose to accomplish the mission; timeless values and sharing a sense of trust with and duty and loyalty to their fellow Soldiers that is unlike any other in the world.

Their willingness to sacrifice for each other, to never leave a fallen comrade, is what makes a Soldier strong - on the battlefield, and off.

When sexual harassment or sexual assault occurs, it is not only a direct violation of our Army Values and Warrior Ethos, but also an assault on what it means to serve in the Profession of Arms and the Army way of life - a life in which it is our duty to protect and take care of each other no matter the time, place, or circumstance. As a band of brothers and sisters, we have a personal and professional duty to intervene and prevent sexual harassment and sexual assault.

As Soldiers, our Army Values demand that we act to stop these behaviors. There are no passive bystanders. Passive bystanders who do not assist, do not report, and do not try to help their fellow Soldiers as they see sexual harassment or sexual assaults occur are part of the problem. We must protect our team members. When we see or sense the risk of sexual harassment or sexual assault, we have a duty to intervene and protect our fellow Soldiers. 1-Notice the Event; 2-Interpret the event as a problem; 3-Accept personal responsibility to do something; 4-Decide how to intervene using the 3Ds (Direct, Distract or Delegate); and 5-Take action.

INTERVENE When I recognize a threat to my fellow Soldiers, I will have the personal courage to **INTERVENE** and prevent sexual assault. I will condemn acts of sexual harassment. I will not abide obscene gestures, language, or behavior. I am a Warrior and a member of a team. I will **INTERVENE**.

ACT You are my brother, my sister, my fellow Soldier. It is my duty to stand up for you, no matter the time or place. I will take **ACTION**. I will do what's right. I will prevent sexual harassment and sexual assault. I will not tolerate sexually offensive behavior. I will **ACT**.

MOTIVATE We are American Soldiers, **MOTIVATED** to keep our fellow Soldiers safe. It is our mission to prevent sexual harassment and sexual assault. We will denounce sexual misconduct. As Soldiers, we are all **MOTIVATED** to take action. We are strongest...together.

Zero tolerance policy

The Army does not tolerate or condone sexual harassment, sexual assault, or associated retaliatory behaviors. These behaviors are incompatible with the Army's high standards of professionalism, discipline, and the Army Ethic, including Army Values.

Commanders are responsible for the success of the SHARP Program, including prevention, annual training activities, compliance with required response actions when acts of sexual harassment or sexual assault are reported, and victim support.

Both male and female Soldiers can be victims or offenders.

Your responsibility as a Soldier is to treat your fellow Soldiers the same as you would treat your buddy, or how you would prefer to be treated. This means if you see a Soldier in danger or trouble, you must take action.

At the Reception Battalion and during the initial phase of BCT and OSUT, Army leaders will provide you with information on sexual harassment and sexual assault; and if you do become a victim, empower you with tools and resources by providing you with options for reporting the incident and getting help.

Sexual Harassment: The Army defines Sexual harassment as:

Conduct that involves unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and deliberate or repeated offensive comments or gestures of a sexual nature when:

Submission to such conduct is either explicitly or implicitly made a term or condition of a person's job, pay or career; or

Submission to or rejection of such conduct by a person is used as a basis for career or employment decisions affecting that person; or

Such conduct has the purpose or effect of unreasonably interfering with an individual's work performance or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working environment; and

Is so severe or pervasive that a reasonable person would perceive, and the victim does perceive, the environment as hostile or offensive.

Any use or condonation, by any person in a supervisory or command position, of any form of sexual behavior to control, influence or affect the career, pay, or job of a member of the Armed Forces or a Civilian employee of the DoD.

Any deliberate or repeated unwelcome verbal comment or gesture of a sexual nature by any member of the Armed Forces or Civilian employee of the DoD.

Examples of the different categories of Sexual Harassment and what they may include:

Verbal:

- Offensive comments or gestures of a sexual nature, making sexual jokes, gestures, remarks, or innuendos.
- Describing certain attributes of one's physical appearance in a sexual manner. Verbal sexual harassment may also include using terms of endearment such as "honey," "babe," "sweetheart," "dear," "stud," or "hunk" in referring to Soldiers,
- Profanity, threats, sexually oriented cadences, or sexual comments; whistling in a sexually suggestive manner.
- Spreading sexual rumors about an individual.
- Persistent, unwanted requests for social (dates) or sexual activity.

- Participating in sexually charged conversations.

Nonverbal:

- Making, transmission using electronic communication and/or posting inappropriate sexual remarks to, or photos of, an Individual via social media sites, text message, or email.
- Offensive printed material (for example, displaying sexually oriented pictures or cartoons) in the workplace.
- Cornering or blocking a passageway; inappropriately or excessively staring at someone; blowing kisses; winking; or licking one's lips in a suggestive manner.
- Conduct of a sexual nature intended to embarrass, intimidate, demean, or degrade.

**Note: "Workplace" is an expansive term for Soldiers and may include conduct on or off duty, 24 hours a day, on or off post.*

Physical contact: Unwanted or inappropriate touching, patting, pinching, bumping, grabbing, kissing, or providing unsolicited back or neck rubs.

Note: There may be overlap between physical contact which constitutes sexual assault and physical contact which constitutes sexual harassment.

The right response:

To determine if conduct falls under the category of sexual harassment, consider the following questions:

- Is the behavior, comment, or gesture sexual in nature?
- Is the behavior, comment, or gesture unwelcomed?
- Does the behavior create a hostile or offensive work environment?
- Have sexual favors been demanded, requested, or suggested (especially as a condition of employment or career and job success)?

Your options:

- Confidential Report: Allows the victim of sexual harassment to file a confidential complaint with the SARC. Confidential reporting does not allow the SHARP professional to confront the subject or resolve the sexual harassment.
- File a Complaint:
 - Anonymous: Encourages reporting and keeps anonymity. Soldiers and adult dependents can make anonymous complaints.
 - Formal complaint: File complaints with Commander or SARCs: Soldiers, adult dependent or Equal Employment Opportunity Office (DA/DoD Civilians). Filed, in writing, using DA Form 7746 and the Commander is notified.
- You can always request direct intervention or speak to a Chaplain and ask for help.

Sexual assault Intentional sexual contact, characterized by use of force, threats, intimidation, or abuse of authority or

when the victim does not or cannot consent. The term includes a broad range of sexual offenses including the following specific UCMJ offenses: rape, sexual assault, aggravated sexual contact, abusive sexual contact, forcible sodomy (forced oral or anal sex), and attempts to commit these acts.

Sexual assault is a crime: Under Article 120 of the UCMJ. Sexual harassment can be a crime under Article 134 or punished under Article 92 as a violation of Army policy. Again, Sexual assault is always a crime, but sexual harassment can be a crime or a regulatory violation.

Examples of Sexual Assault may include:

- Rape and nonconsensual sodomy.
- Performing sexual acts or sexual contact with an individual who cannot give consent because they are sleeping/passed out or too impaired to consent due to alcohol or drugs and the condition is known or reasonably should have been known by the alleged offender. Using physical threats or force to engage in sexual contact with an individual.
- Performing sexual acts or sexual contact with an individual who did not consent. It is the responsibility of both parties to consent. Consent may be given by words or expression, but if there is any question if consent was granted the party must ensure consent is granted.
- Sexual contact without permission, which can include fondling and hazing incidents.

The damage resulting from sexual assault extends far beyond the victim, weakening the very health and morale of our Soldiers, breaking the bond of trust within our team, shattering the confidence Soldiers have in one another, and undermining unit readiness. Sexual assault can be prevented.

What to do if you have been sexually assaulted

If you are sexually assaulted or think you were, go to a safe location away from the perpetrator.

If you want to talk with someone or want assistance, you may contact a Chaplain, healthcare personnel, SHARP VA or SARC. Make sure you understand the difference between a restricted and unrestricted report so that those you reach out to will understand your needs and can best assist you.

Restricted report: Sexual assault victims who want to confidentially disclose a sexual assault without triggering an official investigation AND receive medical treatment, legal assistance, and counseling. Victims may later change their report to an unrestricted report.

Healthcare provider CANNOT accept sexual assault reports. That is, the DD Form 2910 (Victim Reporting Preference Statement) must be done between the victim and a SARC or a VA to consider an official report.

Chaplains will assist and support the victim in contacting a SARC or VA, but the SHARP professional will take the report.

While special victims' counsels, victims' legal counsels, and chaplains have confidentiality/privilege and can have private and confidential communications with victims, they

CANNOT assist a victim with filing an official report. Official reporting can only be done by signing a DD Form 2910 with a SARC or VA.

Unrestricted report: This option triggers an investigation and command notification, while also providing access to medical treatment, counseling, advocacy services, and legal assistance, SARC/SHARP and VA assistance.

Victims do not need to file a report to receive medical, advocacy, legal, and counseling services above, however you must file a report to receive a sexual assault forensics exam (SAFE) and/or victim advocacy services.

Official investigation of the crime

When selecting unrestricted reporting, you may report the incident to the SARC or VA, request healthcare providers to notify law enforcement, contact law enforcement yourself, or use current reporting channels, for instance, your chain of command.

You can also call the DOD Safe helpline at (877) 995-5247 or your local installation helpline for further assistance.

Chapter 10 – Reference Material

10-1. The National Anthem ★

Written by Francis Scott Key in 1814, the Star Spangled Banner was played at military occasions ordered by President Woodrow Wilson in 1916, and in 1931 was designated as our national anthem by an Act of Congress.

The Star-Spangled Banner is the timeless rendition of our sacred American Flag and country's patriotic spirit.

The Star-Spangled Banner ★

Oh, say, can you see, by the dawn's early light,

What so proudly we hailed at the twilight's last gleaming?

Whose broad stripes and bright stars, thro' the perilous fight'

O'er the ramparts we watched were so gallantly streaming.

And the rockets' red glare, the bombs bursting in air, gave proof through the night that our flag was still there. Oh, say, does that Star-Spangled Banner yet wave

O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave?

10-2. The Army Song

★ The Army Song tells the heroic story of our past, present, and future. It was originally written by First Lieutenant Edmund L. Gruber, a Field Artillery officer, in 1908 and it was adopted in 1952 as the official song of our Army. As a time-honored tradition, the song is played at the conclusion of every U.S. Army ceremony in which all Soldiers are expected to stand and proudly sing the lyrics.

Army Song ★

March along, sing our song, with the Army of the free.

Count the brave, count the true, who have fought to victory.

We're the Army and proud of our name! We're the Army and proudly proclaim.

First to fight for the right, And to build the Nation's might, And The Army Goes Rolling Along.

Proud of all we have done, Fighting till the battle's won, And the Army Goes Rolling Along.

Then it's Hi! Hi! Hey! The Army's on its way. Count off the cadence loud and strong.

For where e'er we go, you will always know, That The Army Goes Rolling Along.

10-3. The Code of Conduct

The Code of Conduct is our guide for how all Soldiers, Sailors, Airmen, Marines, and Coast Guard must conduct themselves if captured by the enemy. ★The Code of Conduct, in six brief articles, addresses the intense situations and decisions that to some degree, all military services members could encounter. It contains the critical information for U.S. prisoners of war to survive honorably while faithfully resisting the enemy's efforts of exploitation.

a. I am an American, fighting in the forces which guard my country and our way of life. I am prepared to give my life in their defense.

b. I will never surrender of my own free will. If in command, I will never surrender the members of my command while they still have the means to resist.

c. If I am captured, I will continue to resist by all means available. I will make every effort to escape and aid others to escape. I will accept neither parole nor special favors from the enemy.

d. If I become a prisoner of war, I will keep faith with my fellow prisoners. I will give no information or take part in any action which might be harmful to my comrades. If I am senior, I will take command. If not, I will obey the lawful orders of those appointed over me and will back them up in every way.

e. When questioned, should I become a prisoner of war, I am required to give name, rank, service number, and date of birth. I will evade answering further questions to the utmost of my ability. I will make no oral or written statements disloyal to my country and its allies or harmful to their cause.

f. I will never forget that I am an American, fighting for freedom, responsible for my actions, and dedicated to the principles which made my country free. I will trust in my God and in the United States of America.

Operations security (OPSEC):

OPSEC, is a mindset that all of us must use to protect our mission, personnel, and resources. It denies the adversary CRITICAL and SENSITIVE information about you, your organization, and missions that if observed by your adversary, can be used against us. You might ask: "If it's critical, wouldn't it be classified or something?" OPSEC

protects sensitive and/or critical information from adversary observation and collection in ways that traditional security programs cannot. While these programs, such as Information Assurance (IA), protect classified information, they cannot prevent all indicators of critical information, especially unclassified indicators, from being revealed. In concise terms, the OPSEC process identifies the critical information of military plans, operations, and supporting activities, and the indicators that can reveal it, and develops measures to eliminate, reduce, or conceal those indicators.

So, what is my critical information you may ask? First, check with your leadership, to learn what information your commander has deemed critical. It will be in your commander's Critical Information List, or CIL. It contains information items that are vital to the unit's mission that if an adversary obtains it, correctly analyzes it, and acts upon it; could prevent or seriously degrade our mission success.

What else is critical? A simple acronym to use is CALI (Capabilities, Activities, Limitations, and Intentions). It also includes items marked as Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI), Personally Identifiable Information, and sensitive medical information. It may also include credit card numbers, security codes, passwords, home security, financial history, and vacation plans. Always ask yourself, "What would an adversary or bad guy do with the information?"

Who are the adversaries?

Insiders. Those with misguided or divided loyalties, careless or disgruntled employees.

Foreign Intelligence services (spies), or allied nations that collect to gain advantages over the US.

Terrorists, criminals, hackers, scam artists, identity thieves, and the list goes on.

How do they get my information?

Social Engineering. Phone calls, emails (phishing), requests for information about you or your organization. Is that really your bank or another unit asking for your information?

Surveillance. What is in your trash/recycle bins, public web pages (.mil and unit social media sites), in your work area, or in your unencrypted emails? What discussions are you having in public?

Phishing. Socially engineered email might contain infected attachments and/or hyperlinks that lead to web sites hosting malware.

Personal Mobile Devices. Hackers are rapidly developing malicious applications and programs for new technologies. Very little security is built-in or readily available on these devices.

Social Media. What are you, your family, and fellow employees posting, texting, or placing on social media? Can it be used to social engineer or extort you? Can terrorists or criminals target you? Will it cause you or your unit harm or embarrassment?

How do I protect our critical information?

Encrypt your emails.

DO NOT discard CUI or other critical information in **trash or recycle bins**.

Always think that your adversary will see all your web postings and **social media** comments.

Ask yourself, “what could the wrong person do with this information?” and “could it compromise the safety of me, my family or my unit?”

Talk to your family and friends about OPSEC. They need to know what is critical and how to protect it from unscrupulous characters and adversaries. They are proud of you and want to talk and post information about you, however, they need to know the risks.

We all need to do our part to protect our fellow Soldiers.

Our adversaries are always on the lookout for us to show our capabilities, activities, limitations, and intentions (CALI).

Do your part to keep our Army strong and practice good OPSEC!

10-4. Army Organizations

Active Army and Reserve Component

The U.S. Army consists of the Active Army, the Army National Guard (ARNG) and the United States Army Reserve (USAR).

Army unit organizations

The squad/section is the smallest unit, consisting of eight to ten Soldiers. You will be assigned to a squad or a section when you report to your first unit.

The platoon includes the Platoon leader, Platoon Sergeant, and two or more squads assigned (normally 4 squads).

The company includes the company commander, first sergeant, and two or more platoons (normally 3 to 4 squads per platoon).

The battalion includes the battalion commander, his or her staff and headquarters, the command sergeant major, and approximately 3-5 companies.

The brigade consists of two to five battalions. It includes the brigade commander, command sergeant major, and a headquarters/staff.

Chapter 11 – Sponsorship and Soldier for Life

11-1. Total Army Sponsorship Program

The Total Army Sponsorship Program outlined in AR 600-8-8 is a prescribed system which helps commanders exercise their basic responsibility for the successful reception and integration of Soldiers and Families into their unit, installation, facility, and community. Sponsorship is a commander's program where success can be measured by the level of involvement by a Soldier's chain of command and sponsors. It provides principles of support, standards of service, policies, functions, and tasks governing the program.

The Total Army Sponsorship Program (TASP) is available within the ACT website, <https://actnow.army.mil/>, where EAMS-A Username and Password, Multi-Factor

Authentication (MFA), or Common Access Card (CAC) is required to access ACT (Username and Password or MFA enables access to ACT utilizing your mobile device).

You will receive a sponsor from your first unit of assignment. Sponsors greet incoming Soldiers and their Family members in accordance with unit policy and assist during initial inprocessing, as needed. After initial inprocessing, sponsors will provide assistance on a decreasing level based on the Soldier's ability to function independently. The sponsor will encourage and coach new arrivals to function independently in the community as soon as possible. Sponsors are not responsible for performing such tasks as childcare, grocery shopping, laundry, house hunting, and other functions best performed by the new arrivals and not directly related to sponsorship.

11-2. Soldier for Life Program

The U.S. Army established the Soldier for Life initiative in 1997 and increased its focus in July 2012. The intent was to inspire Soldiers to identify as Soldiers for Life, always remain proud of their service to the Nation, and conduct themselves as honorable men and women throughout their lives not only as Soldiers but as Civilians. When Soldiers return to society as private citizens, they remain moral-ethical exemplars for their Families and communities. Every veteran of honorable service and Army retiree is a Soldier for Life and continues to contribute to the well-being of the United States of America. In 2012, the Army Transition Assistance Program was renamed the Soldier for Life Program and redesigned to enhance employment preparation and opportunities for Soldiers leaving the Army

after honorable service. Along with the Army Career and Alumni Program (ACAP), the enhanced Soldier for Life program was established to maintain trust with our Army Family during and after service. This program is designed to enable Soldiers, Retired Soldiers, Veterans, and Families to leave military service “Career Ready”, and connect to an established network to find employment, education, and health resources. It focuses on the current serving population to instill the Soldier for Life mindset of service.

The Soldier for Life - Transition Assistance Program promotes lifelong learning, individual development, and transition-related requirements throughout a Soldier’s military Career. This program combines employment and education workshops and seminars tailored to prepare and connect transitioning Soldiers to meaningful civilian employment and education opportunities.

Soldier for Life Centers are located on installations, posts, camps, and stations where Soldiers and Families can find resources to assist them in making educated decisions and sound plans during all phases of their military lives: in-service, and post transition.

The Soldier’s for Life goal is to “Start Strong, Serve Strong, and Continue Strong.”

Once a Soldier, Always a Soldier...*a Soldier for Life!*

Chapter 12 – Soldier Debit Card

While at the reception battalion you will be issued a Visa U.S. debit card. This is a form of advance payment provided to every Soldier to purchase items needed for BCT. The advance pay will be deducted from your first paycheck, Males \$350, Females \$756. The payment amount may change due to updated policy. Upon receipt of the U.S. debit card every Trainee must immediately call the card service center (1-800 number) and establish a PIN to protect your personal account. You can retain the U.S. debit card and use wherever Visa is accepted.

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Appendix A – References

Unless otherwise indicated, TRADOC publications and forms are available on the TRADOC Administrative Publications website, <https://adminpubs.tradoc.army.mil/>. DA publications and forms are available on the Army Publishing Directorate website, <https://armypubs.army.mil/>. DOD issuances and forms are available on the Executive Services Division website, <https://www.esd.whs.mil/DD/>.

Section I

Required Publications

This section contains no entries.

Section II

Related Publications

Army Regulation 40-501
Standards of Medical Fitness

Army Regulation 600-4
Remission or Cancellation of Indebtedness

Army Regulation 600-8-8
The Total Army Sponsorship Program

Army Regulation 600-8-19
Enlisted Promotions and Reductions

Army Regulation 600-8-22
Military Awards

TRADOC Pamphlet 600-4

Army Regulation 600-20
Army Command Policy

Army Regulation 600-25
Salutes, Honors, and Courtesy

Army Regulation 670-1
Wear and Appearance of Army Uniforms and Insignia

Army Techniques Publication 7-22.01
Holistic Health and Fitness Testing

Army Techniques Publication 7-22.02
Holistic Health and Fitness Drills and Exercises

DA Pamphlet 670-1
Guide to the Wear and Appearance of Army Uniforms and
Insignia

Field Manual 7-22
Holistic Health and Fitness

STP-21-1-SMCT
Soldier's Manual of Common Tasks Warrior Skills Level 1

Training Circular 3-21.5
Drill and Ceremonies

UCMJ (Appendix 2 of the Manual for Courts martial)
(Available on the Joint Service Component website,
[https://jsc.defense.gov/Military-Law/Current-Publications-
and-Updates/](https://jsc.defense.gov/Military-Law/Current-Publications-and-Updates/))

Warfighter Nutrition Guide, May 2022. Human Performance Resources by CHAMP (Available at <https://www.hprc-online.org/nutrition/warfighter-nutrition-guide>)

Section III

Prescribed Forms

This section contains no entries.

Section IV

Referenced Forms

DA Form 2028

Recommended Changes to Publications and Blank Forms

DA Form 705-TEST

Army Fitness Test Scorecard

DA Form 5434

Sponsorship Program Counseling and Information Sheet

DA Form 7279

Equal Opportunity and Harassment Complaint

DD Form 1380

Tactical Combat Casualty Care (TCCC) Card (*Available through normal publications supply channels.*)

DD Form 2982

Recruiter/Trainer Prohibited Activities Acknowledgment

DD Form 2983

Recruit/Trainee Prohibited Activities Acknowledgment

Section V **Websites**

Army Career Tracker, <https://actnow.army.mil/>

Army Credentialing Opportunities On- Line,
<https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/index.html>

Army Emergency Relief,
<https://www.armyemergencyrelief.org/>

Army Family and New Spouse Orientation video,
<https://www.military.com/spouse/military-life/checklist-for-new-military-spouses.html>

Army University (Credentialing),
<https://armyuniversity.edu/ACCESS/ca.>

Department of Veterans Affairs (Servicemember's Life Insurance),
<https://www.benefits.va.gov/insurance/index.asp>

DOD Military Compensation (Blended Retirement System),
<https://militarypay.defense.gov/BlendedRetirement/>

Military OneSource, <https://www.militaryonesource.mil/>

My Army Benefits, <https://myarmybenefits.us.army.mil/>

MyPay, <https://mypay.dfas.mil/>

Office of Army's General Counsel (Ethics & Fiscal),
<https://ogc.altess.army.mil/EandF/Documentation/ethicsmaterial.aspx>

Operation Supplement Safety, <https://www.opss.org/>

Red Cross, <https://www.redcross.org/>

Thrift Savings Plan, <https://www.tsp.gov/>

TRICARE, <https://www.tricare.mil/>

TRICARE Dental Program,
<https://www.tricare.mil/Plans/DentalPlans>

U.S. Army Soldier For Life,
<https://www.soldierforlife.army.mil/>

USA JOBS, <https://armycivilianservice.usajobs.gov/>

USMAP: <https://usmap.osd.mil/armyMOS.htm>

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Appendix B – Army Resources

B-1. Servicemembers' Group Life Insurance (SGLI)

As a United States Soldier, you may encounter hostile situations while stationed abroad and in combat. The well-being of your Family is of the greatest concern to the Army.

One of the many benefits afforded Soldiers is the opportunity to purchase very low-cost life insurance. SGLI provides up to a maximum of \$500,000. SGLI automatically covers you for this maximum amount unless you select, in writing, a lesser amount, in increments of \$50,000. You may also decline SGLI altogether, but this decision is so important that you must also do that in writing. The payment is deducted automatically from your pay each month. Soldiers with Families almost always select coverage in the maximum amount.

Spouses and children are eligible for Family SGLI. Coverage for a spouse is automatically \$100,000 unless a lesser amount, in steps of \$10,000, is chosen.

Visit the Servicemember's Life Insurance page on the Department of Veterans Affairs website at <https://www.benefits.va.gov/insurance/index.asp> for additional information and assistance with enrollment.

B-2. Dental

The level of dental care will vary from post to post, but it is available for all Soldiers. Family member care is generally not available at military dental facilities, but many locations now offer civilian dental practices on military installations.

Family members may receive dental insurance through the TRICARE Dental Program (TDP). The TDP is dental insurance in which you pay a monthly fee in exchange for Family coverage. It is a voluntary, cost effective, comprehensive program offered worldwide by the Department of Defense to Family members of all active-duty branches of the military, Selected Reserve, and Individual Ready Reserve members.

Family members must be registered in DEERS to be eligible for the TRICARE Dental Program.

To participate, the Soldier must have 12 months remaining on their service commitment at the time of enrollment and submit an enrollment form with the first month's premium or enroll online using a charge card. The monthly premiums will typically be deducted from the Soldier's pay, although there are other payment options.

Depending on the dental procedures performed, treatment may be completely covered by the insurance, or there may be co-payments.

There is a maximum annual amount that TRICARE will pay for any one beneficiary. Once that yearly amount is reached for the individual, all costs above the maximum must be paid by the Family.

When permitted, complete information and instructions on how to enroll and find a local dental provider are available on-line at the TRICARE Dental site,
<http://www.tricare.mil/CoveredServices/Dental.aspx>.

B-3. Army Emergency Relief

Army Emergency Relief (AER) is a private nonprofit organization incorporated in 1942 by the Secretary of War and the Army Chief of Staff. AER's mission is to provide emergency financial assistance to Soldiers and their Families.

What can AER do?

Help with emergency financial needs for:

- Food, rent, or utilities
- Emergency transportation and vehicle repair
- Funeral expenses
- Medical/dental expenses
- College scholarships to children, spouses, and surviving spouses of Soldiers
- Additional Benefits:
 - Lifetime membership in the Army Air Force Mutual Aid Association for surviving Families of Soldiers who die on active duty.
 - Grants for wounded Soldiers medically evacuated from a theater of combat.
 - Personal Financial Management Training for Soldiers in AIT.

Who is eligible?

- Active-duty Soldiers, single or married, and their Family members.

- Army National Guard and Army Reserve Soldiers on continuous active duty for more than 30 days and their Family members (Title 10, USC).
- Soldiers retired from active duty for longevity or physical disability, and their Family members.
- Army National Guard and Army Reserve Soldiers who retired at age 60, and their Family members.
- Surviving spouses and orphans of Soldiers who died while on active duty or after they retired.

How do I get assistance?

- Through your unit chain of command and the installation AER section.
- If there is no AER section near you, you can get assistance through:
- American Red Cross (local chapter, or 24-hour emergency services)
- Air Force Base (Air Force Aid Society)
- Navy/Marine Corps Base (Navy-Marine Corps Relief Society)
- Coast Guard Base (Coast Guard Mutual Assistance)

Can my spouse get AER help if I'm away?

Yes. Your spouse should bring:

- Power of Attorney
- Military identification card
- Substantiating documents

What kind of assistance can I expect?

- An interest free loan.
- A grant if repayment of loan will cause undue hardship.
- Part loan and part grant.

How can I help AER?

- Remind fellow Soldiers about AER when they experience financial emergencies.
- Support AER with a contribution and encourage others to contribute.
- The Army-wide annual AER fund campaign is conducted 1 March –15 May.
- You can contribute to your local AER fund campaign or send your contribution to AER National Headquarters.
- All contributions are tax deductible.
- Unsolicited donations are accepted any time by mail or online.

For more information contact your local AER officer or visit the AER website. <https://www.armyemergencyrelief.org/>.

B-4. The Army Credentialing Program (ACP)

The ACP enables Soldiers to capitalize on training and development opportunities throughout their military careers so that they can grow and develop as a Soldier. The three voluntary programs in the ACP portfolio are:

1. The United Services Military Apprenticeship Program (USMAP)

While actively serving, you have the chance to enhance your job skills and accomplish civilian apprenticeship requirements through formal training. A dynamic blend of hands-on experience and relevant technical instruction, resulting in credentials being recognized by industries far and wide. These credentials, coupled with Department of Labor certification as a journey worker, open doors to remarkable career advancement.

2. Institutionally Delivered Credentialing (IDC)

IDCs aren't just certifications, they're pathways to expertise in your specific Military Occupational Specialties, Areas of Concentration, and courses. Gaining specialized skills that set you apart.

These credentials can be accessed while attending Army Training Centers, NCO Academies, and professional military education schools. Funding covers a comprehensive range, from course fees to licensing exams and study materials to expert guidance. Contact your Schoolhouse point of contact before attending any professional military education for IDC opportunities.

3. Credentialing Assistance Program (CA)

The Army CA Program is your invitation to propel your future – both during your military service and beyond.

Choose courses and exams that resonate with your career aspirations. Whether you're looking to elevate your skills within your current MOS or aiming for a new

occupational horizon that is not aligned to your MOS, post-military service. You can secure CA funding for any credential listed in Army COOL, every year.

Information for USMAP and IDC is found at participating Army schools, while information on CA is found at your local Education Office/Center. Additional resources:

- USMAP: <https://usmap.osd.mil/armyMOS.htm>
- Army COOL: <https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/>, (select “Institutionally Delivered Credentialing” or “Credentialing Assistance Program”)
- Soldier for Life, Education web page, <https://soldierforlife.army.mil/Education/>
- Army University, Army Credentialing and Continuing Education Services for Soldiers (ACCESS) web page, <https://armyuniversity.edu/ACCESS/ca>

Soldiers in some fields are *required* to earn credentials, such as a Federal Aviation Association license for Air Traffic Controllers, but for most Soldiers, credentialing programs are voluntary.

B-5. Information websites for family members

The Army recognizes the important role that spouses and Family members play in supporting Soldiers and in keeping our Army communities strong.

Each Army installation has its own website that is full of useful information for your Family and can be found by searching for the name of the installation on the internet.

Be sure to look for the official sites ending in “.mil” or “.gov” in the web address. Useful websites to vital information sources were provided throughout this publication, with additional sources listed below.

It is extremely important to you and the Army that we link your Family members with resources to help integrate them into the Army lifestyle.

Use these websites and the others cited in this book as you progress through your career from BCT to your first unit of assignment. (See Appendix A for consolidated list of websites and their links).

They will provide a wide variety of information to your Family and help them progress with you throughout your Army career.

- Start here with the “Army Family and New Spouse Orientation” video:
<https://www.military.com/spouse/military-life/checklist-for-new-military-spouses.html>
- Military OneSource answers hundreds of Family-related questions:
<https://www.militaryonesource.mil/>.
- Army Google Workspace (Army GWS) replaced Army Knowledge on-line accounts. Allows you to create an Army email account to notify your sponsor and receive information.
- The Army gives spouses an employment preference to support the Servicemember’s duty assignments. Army Civilian Service employment opportunities

may be found on the USA JOBS website,
<https://armycivilianservice.usajobs.gov/>.

- Family members new to Army life can find information on all benefits the Army provides at the My Army Benefits website,
<https://myarmybenefits.us.army.mil/>.
- Contact the Red Cross, <https://www.redcross.org/> to notify a Servicemember of a Family emergency and/or search for your local Red Cross representative.
- The official TRICARE website,
<https://www.tricare.mil/> is where you and your Family members can find information on military healthcare coverage at www.tricare.mil.
- Visit the TRICARE Dental Program online,
<https://www.tricare.mil/Plans/DentalPlans> for local dentists in your area and information regarding dental care at www.tricare.mil/dental/TDP.aspx
- Your LES and other pay information can be obtained from the official MyPay Homepage,
<https://mypay.dfas.mil/>.
- Army COOL (Credentialing Opportunities On- Line),
<https://www.cool.osd.mil/army/credsearch/index.html>
- Army Career Tracker, <https://actnow.army.mil/>.

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Glossary

AAFES	Army Air Force exchange services
ACE	Ask, Care, Escort
AFT	Army Fitness Test
ACT	Army Career Tracker
ACP	Army Credentialing Program
ACU	Army combat uniform
AER	Army Emergency Relief
AGSU	Army Green Service Uniform
AIT	advanced individual training
ALARACT	all Army activities (Army general message address)
APFU	Army Physical Fitness Uniform
AR	Army Regulation
ARNG	Army National Guard
ASU	Army service uniform
ASVAB	Armed services vocational aptitude battery
BCT	Basic Combat Training
CA	Credentialing Assistance
DEERS	Defense Enrollment Eligibility Reporting System
DA	Department of the Army
DD	Department of Defense (form)
DNA	Deoxyribonucleic acid
FICA	Federal Insurance Contributions Act
FM	Field manual
FTX	field training exercise
FUA	first unit of assignment
GWS	Google Workspace (Army)
HPDT	high physical demand test
IET	Initial Entry Training

LDRSHIP	Loyalty, Duty, Respect, Selfless Service, Honor, Integrity, and Personal Courage
LES	leave and earning statement
MEO	military equal opportunity
MEPS	military entrance processing station
MOS	military occupational specialty
NCO	noncommissioned officer
OPAT	Occupational Physical Assessment Test
OSUT	One Station Unit Training
PL	Platoon leader
PSG	Platoon sergeant
SARC	sexual assault response coordinator
SFL	Soldier for life
SGLI	Service Member's Group Life Insurance
SHARP	Sexual Harassment/Assault Response And Prevention
SOP	Standard operating procedure
STP	Soldier Training Publication
SQD LDR	Squad leader
TASP	Total Army Sponsorship Program
TRICARE	Tri-service Health Care
USAR	U.S. Army Reserve
VA	victim advocate
WTBDs	warrior tasks and battle drills

Army Definitions

A

Advanced Individual Training - a training course where Soldiers learn skills in a specific military occupational specialty.

Army Values - values that characterize the Army's professionalism and culture, and describe the ethical standards expected of all Soldiers.

Army Emergency Relief - A private nonprofit organization incorporated in 1942 by the Secretary of War and the Army Chief of Staff to assist Soldiers.

Army Ethics - The evolving set of laws, values, and beliefs, embedded within the Army culture of trust that motivates and guides the conduct of Army professionals bound together in common moral purpose.

Army Professional - A member of the Army Profession who meets the Army's certification criteria of competence, character, and commitment.

B

Base - the element around which a movement is planned or regulated.

Basic Allowance for Housing (BAH).

Basic Combat Training - a training course that transforms civilians into Soldiers.

Buddy team - two Soldiers in the same unit who look after each other at all times.

Bugle call - the musical signal that announces scheduled and certain non-scheduled events on an Army installation.

C

Cadence - a uniform rhythm or number of steps or counts per minute.

Chaplain - a spiritual support officer available to every Soldier.

Code of Conduct - guidance on how a Soldier must conduct him or herself if captured by the enemy.

Commissioned officer - an officer who is commissioned into the U.S. Army, leaders with the authority to command Soldiers.

Conditioning drill - a strength and mobility activity that helps Soldiers improve their functional strength, postural alignment, and body mechanics as the exercises relate to the quality performance of Warrior Tasks and Battle Drills.

D

Distance - the space between elements that are one behind the other; the distance between individuals is an arm's length, plus 6 inches, (152.4 mm) or approximately 36 inches (914.4 mm) measured from the chest of one Soldier to the back of the Soldier immediately to his front.

Double time - a cadence of 180 counts (steps per minute).

Drill command - an oral order given by a commander or leader, usually in two parts; the preparatory command states the movement to be carried out and gets you ready to execute the order; the command of execution tells when the movement is to be carried out.

Drill sergeant - a highly educated, qualified noncommissioned officer and the primary instructor in IET who transforms civilians into Soldiers.

Duty - to fulfill your obligations.

E

Element - an individual, squad, section, platoon, company, or larger unit formed as part of the next higher unit.

Equal opportunity - equal treatment for military personnel, and civilian employees without regard to race, color, religion, sex, or national origin.

F

File - a column that has a front of one element.

Formal complaint - Allegation of unlawful discrimination and/or harassment that is submitted in writing to proper authority and processed through official complaint channels.

Formation - an arrangement of the unit's elements in a prescribed manner such as a line formation in which the elements are side-by-side, and column formation in which the elements are one behind the other.

Fraternization - personal relationships between Soldiers of different grades (including between permanent party members and IET Soldiers); regardless of Service or sex; that create an actual or clearly predictable perception of undue familiarity; compromise or appear to compromise the integrity of supervisory authority or the chain of command; cause actual or perceived partiality or unfairness; involve, or appear to involve, the improper use of grade or rank or position for personal gain; are or are perceived to be, exploitative or coercive in nature; or create an actual or clearly predictable adverse impact on discipline, authority, morale, or the ability of the command to accomplish its mission. Violations are punishable under the UCMJ.

Front - a space from one side to the other side of a formation and includes the right and left elements.

G

Guide - the person responsible for maintaining the prescribed direction and rate of march.

H

Head - a column's leading element.

Honor - to live up to the Army Values.

I

Informal complaint - Allegations of unlawful discrimination, harassment (hazing, bullying, or discriminatory harassment), or sexual harassment that do not require written documentation. These complaints may be voiced to the offending party, to someone in a position of authority, or both. The intention is that the offending behavior will cease with no further action required.

Interval - the space between side-by-side elements.

L

Leave and earnings statement - a detailed pay statement issued at the end of each month to military service members, retirees, and DA civilians; statement contains nine sections related to military earnings and leave.

Loyalty - to bear true faith and allegiance to the U.S. Constitution, the Army, your unit, and other Soldiers.

M

Marksmanship badge - a badge awarded to individuals who qualify, because they have demonstrated some special proficiency or skill; a badge worn to indicate the individual's prowess with specific weapons, pistols,

and/or rifles and during specified competitions, matches, or practice exercises.

Medal - Commemorative, campaign, and service medals are issued to Soldiers who take part in particular campaigns or periods of service for which a medal is authorized.

Medal of Honor - the highest and most rarely awarded decoration conferred by the U.S. The medal is awarded for conspicuous gallantry and intrepidity at the risk of his or her life above and beyond the call of duty while engaged in an action against an enemy of the U.S.

Military time - a timetable based on the 24-hour clock system.

N

Noncommissioned officer (NCO) - a senior enlisted technical expert, combat leader, mentor, and primary advisor to the commander.

O

Oath of Enlistment - the oath Soldiers make to officially enlist into the U. S. Army; the oath to support and defend the United States of America and the U.S. Constitution

One-Station-Unit-Training (OSUT) - basic combat training and advanced individual training combined into one course.

Occupational Physical Assessment Test (OPAT) - Test to assess physical ability to perform certain requirements to receive training for a specific occupation in the Army.

P

Personal courage - to face and overcome fear, danger, or adversity (physical or moral).

Platoon sergeant - a highly educated Non-Commissioned Officer who supervises, manages Soldiers, and trains skills in a specific military occupational specialty.

Post - the correct place for an officer or NCO to stand in a prescribed formation.

Purple Heart - a medal awarded to persons serving in any capacity as a member of the Armed Forces who are killed or wounded (requiring treatment by a medical officer) in any action against enemies of the U.S.

Q

Quick time - a cadence of 120 counts (steps per minute).

R

Rank - a line that is only one element in depth.

Relationship (physical or sexual) - relationships between IET Soldiers and other IET Soldiers; regardless of Service or sex; violations punishable under UCMJ.

Respect - to treat people as they should be treated.

Restricted reporting - Restricted reporting allows a Soldier and/or an adult Family member 18 years or older who is a sexual assault victim, on a confidential basis, to disclose the details of his/her assault to specifically identified individuals and receive medical treatment and counseling, without triggering the official investigative process. Soldiers and qualified Family members who are sexually assaulted and desire restricted reporting under this policy should report the assault to the SARC, VA, or a healthcare provider.

Risk management - a decision-making process used to identify and eliminate or reduce risks associated with *all* hazards that have the potential to injure or kill personnel,

damage, or destroy equipment, or otherwise impact mission effectiveness.

S

Sexual assault response coordinator (SARC) - The SARC is the single point of contact within an organization or installation that oversees sexual assault awareness, prevention, and response training; coordinates medical treatment, including emergency care, for victims of sexual assault; and tracks the services provided to a victim of sexual assault from the initial report through final disposition and resolution. The SARC is responsible for ensuring that victims of sexual assault receive appropriate and responsive care. Upon notification of a sexual assault and after receiving consent from the victim, the SARC will assign a VA to assist the victim. SARCs supervise VAs but are authorized to perform VA duties if required.

Selfless Service - to put the welfare of the Nation, the Army, and your subordinates before your own.

Service Member's Group Life Insurance (SGLI) - military life insurance.

Sexual Assault - Intentional sexual contact characterized using force, threats, intimidation, or abuse of authority or when the victim does not or cannot consent. As used in this regulation, the term includes a broad category of sexual offenses consisting of the following specific UCMJ offenses: rape, sexual assault, aggravated sexual contact, abusive sexual contact, forcible sodomy (forced oral or anal sex), or attempts to commit these offenses.

Sexual Contact - Touching or causing another person to touch, either directly or through the clothing, the vulva, penis, scrotum, anus, groin, breast, inner thigh, or buttocks of any person. With an intent to abuse, humiliate, harass or

degrade any person, or to arouse or gratify the sexual desire of any person. Touching may be accomplished by any part of the body or an object.

Sexual harassment - Conduct that involves unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and deliberate or repeated offensive comments of a general nature when: Submission to such conduct is either explicitly or implicitly a term or condition of a person's job, pay or career; or submission to or rejection of such conduct by a person is used as a basis for career or employment decisions affecting that person; or such conduct has the purpose or effect of unreasonably interfering with an individual's work performance or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working environment and is so severe or pervasive that a reasonable person would perceive and the victim does perceive, the environment as hostile or offensive. Any use or condonation, by any person in a supervisory or command position, of any form of sexual behavior to control, influence or affect the career, pay, or job of a member of the armed forces or a DA Civilian employee. Any deliberate or repeated unwelcome verbal comment or gesture of a sexual nature related to the work environment by any member of the Armed Forces or DA Civilian employee.

Soldier - a highly dedicated, uniformed member of the U.S. Army who stands ready to defend the United States from its enemies.

Soldierization - an extensive five-phase training program in Initial Entry Training.

Soldier Training Publication (STP) - Manuals used to identify training.

T

Thrift Savings Plan - a Federal Government-sponsored retirement savings and investment plan.

TRADOC - Training and Doctrine Command.

TRICARE - the Department of Defense's worldwide health care program available to eligible beneficiaries from the uniformed services.

U

Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ) – the body of laws containing the substantive and procedural law that governs members of the armed forces and the military courts.

Unrestricted Reporting - Unrestricted reporting allows a Soldier or eligible DA Civilian who is sexually assaulted and desires medical treatment, counseling, and an official investigation of their allegation to use current reporting channels (for example, the chain of command or law enforcement), or they may report the incident to the SARC or SHARP VA. Upon notification of a reported sexual assault, the SARC will immediately notify a SHARP VA. Additionally, with the victim's consent, the healthcare provider will conduct a forensic examination, which may include the collection of evidence. Details regarding the incident will be limited to only those personnel who have a legitimate need-to-know.

Victim advocate (VA) - Provides non-clinical crisis intervention, referral, and ongoing non-clinical support to victims. Support includes providing information on available options and resources to victims. The VA, on behalf of the sexual assault victim, provides liaison assistance with other organizations and agencies on victim care matters and reports directly to the SARC when performing victim

advocacy duties. VA services are available 24 hours per day, 7 days per week.

W

Warrant officer - a technical expert, combat leader, trainer, and advisor skilled in a specific technical specialty

Warrior tasks and battle drills (WTBDs) - the critical skills Soldiers are taught in Initial Entry Training; skills Soldiers train on and use throughout their Army career.





The United States of America exists because there is a U.S. Army, which is arguably the best land force the world has ever seen. The U.S. Army is an institution founded on values and a bedrock of trust between it and the American people it serves. The U.S. Army Soldier is professional, disciplined, and reflects the best of our country.

The title of Soldier is never given, it is earned, and what is earned is yours forever. Like the men and women that came before you, from the earliest days of the Revolutionary War to the Mountains of Afghanistan and the deserts of Iraq, the responsibility of defending our nation will be yours. When you graduate Basic Training, you will have earned the right to be called Soldier and your name will forever be associated with the greatest Army on Earth.

There are no ex-Soldiers, only Soldiers. Whether you decide to complete one enlistment or make the Army your career, upon completion of honorable service, you will have earned the title of Veteran or Retired Soldier but will always be a Soldier for Life. U.S. Army Soldiers, Veterans and Retirees are the strength in our communities and the leaders of our country; you will be that leader.

Once a Soldier, Always a Soldier...a Soldier for Life!

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